MINJOK HERALD

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Dearest Readers,

It feels as if it was only a few months ago when I first became the editor of Minjok Herald back in February of 2023. Lots of events have happened ever since, and the past semester itself starting from the heat of summer to the snow that covers the entire campus was full of tears of both joy and sadness. KMLA is a place of dreams with so many dynamic activities in and out of the classroom that put a smile on our faces, but at the same time, it's a place where everyone cries themselves in exhaustion, fear, and hopelessness. Living in such an environment sometimes tears us more than we expect. Not only for individuals, but for school as a whole I'm sure all readers of Minjok Herald would've experienced the most dramatic events of KMLA this semester. We've experienced sparks of action from both teachers and students, truly showing what KMLA spirit is. What we've learned as KMLA family members is that anything is possible as long as we wish for it with our entire hearts and souls.

It is with heartfelt joy—and a pinch of sadness—that we present the 69th edition of Minjok Herald. This edition of 'Dream' is aimed at flourishing and awakening the dreams of KMLA students, as well as teachers, graduates, and future freshmen of KMLA. As Asha from "Wish", the celebration of Disney 100 years, says "The stars are there to guide us, to inspire us, and to remind us to believe in possibility.", we hope this edition of Minjok Herald is the star to guide your heart to your wish. We live in a world full of endless possibilities. Through mind-blowing stories of over 15 graduated alumni, 3 past teachers, and parents, who will be our forever 'KMLA Family,' hopefully, the spirit of hope and spark of passion within you are triggered, delivering you to the next enchanting chapter of life. Presently, our current students have actively engaged in an exploration of the current state of KMLA and the future trajectory we aspire to shape. Hopefully, knocking towards the future opens the door to crashing waves of growth and development in our community. Valentino from "Wish" says, "The greater the challenge we are willing to face, the greater the life we live." Perhaps the challenge we all faced this semester was our red carpet toward the great life we all will live.

It has been truly a great honor and happiness to work as the Editor-in-Chief of the Minjok Herald for the past year. To the most fabulous crew members, thank you to each and every single one of you and the best supervisor teacher in Minjok Herald's history. Every week, I found myself laughing and crying, crying and laughing with all your articles, passion, and commitment, memories that I'll treasure forever. I am so grateful to have worked with not anyone else but you for the past year. As hard as it is to say goodbye, I could not be more assured in the people who will lead Minjok Herald to its next chapter. With best wishes to our next chief editor, Sangmin Lee, I'm sure that your brilliant instincts, love towards your endless work, and kindness will bring Minjok Herald to its best potential. With this to the end, the Minjok Herald always promises to be the star of KMLA, filling you with shining glitters to you and KMLA's dreams.

Thank you.

With every remaining trace of love,

Inyoung Yi

The Minjok Herald

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Dear New KMLA Family Members, Welcome Home!

A vibrant tapestry of anticipation unfolded last Monday as over 150 first-year students, accompanied by the promise of a fresh academic journey, arrived at Dukgo. While the first-year students commenced their educational adventure, juniors and seniors had already embarked on the first semester of 2024 a day earlier, signaling the beginning of a transformative period following a short winter vacation. The 27th wavers transitioned into Seniors, while the 28th wavers assumed their roles as juniors.

The dawn of the new semester on February 6th was marked by a spirited morning assembly. The entire KMLA family, comprised of juniors, seniors, and dedicated teachers, united in welcoming the 29th wavers.

The morning assembly also welcomed Dr. Go Choi, the new biology teacher, who received a warm embrace from students during his introductory speech. As we embark on this new semester, the KMLA community looks forward to a period filled with diverse experiences, challenges, and the creation of lasting memories under the guidance of our esteemed educators.

The incoming 29th wavers were treated to a special welcoming ceremony during the assembly, where they bowed alongside the 27th and 28th wavers, eliciting applause from the school community. Interim Principal Dr.

Hwang delivered a heartfelt welcoming speech, setting a tone of enthusiasm for the newest members of the KMLA family under the leadership of Head Master Hasik Park.

The initiation period for the 29th wavers will extend over a month, encompassing activities such as a school tour, club presentations, meetings with the 27th wavers, digital detox days, and sports day. February proves to be a bustling month not only for freshmen but also for juniors and seniors, who actively participate in orientation programs for the 29th wave while diligently preparing for upcoming quizzes and exams, including the SATs for the 27th wavers now transitioning into their Senior year.



On March 1st, Entrance Ceremony for 29th wavers were held along with welcoming ceremony for the new head master. Returning to our institution, Dr. Hasik Park assumes the role of Head Master, bringing with him a wealth of experience and a visionary approach to education.

Dr. Park's association with our school spans back to 1997, where he served as a teacher and deputy headmaster until 2004. During this tenure, he played a pivotal role in instituting the nation's first Advanced Placement (AP) exams, solidifying our school's reputation for academic excellence. We eagerly look forward to positive changes and a renewed commitment to holistic education under his visionary leadership.

Amidst the academic hustle and bustle, the Minjok Herald extends its warmest wishes for a successful semester to all students and faculty. With the appointment of Head Master Hasik Park, the corridors of KMLA are poised for an exciting academic odyssey, marked by bright smiles, high hopes, and a commitment to excellence. Congratulations to the 29th wavers and Dr. Hasik Park on officially joining the KMLA family, and may the next three years be filled with joy, growth, and remarkable achievements.

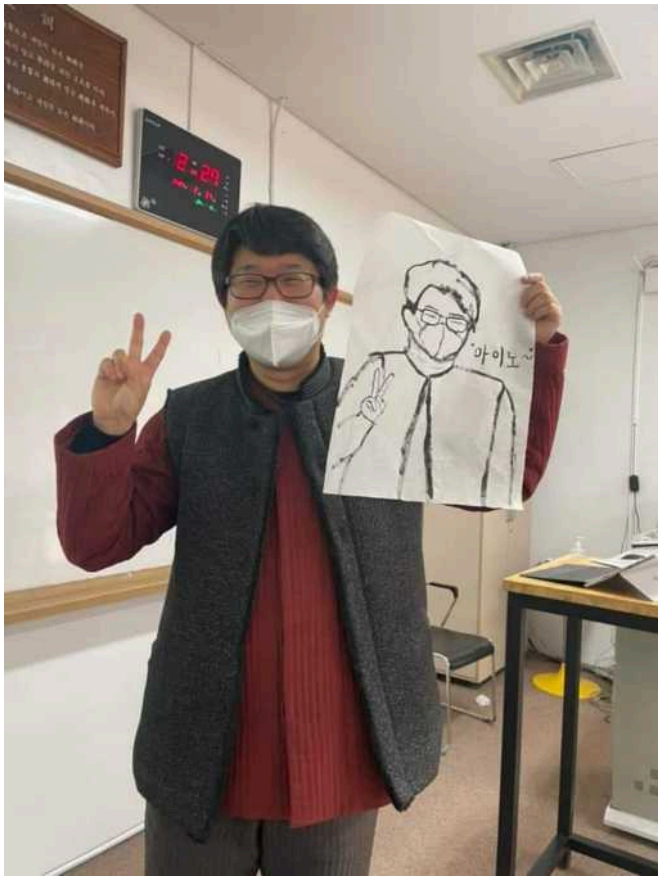
Exploring the new teachers of KMLA

Our forever heroes, role models, 2nd parents

Welcome to KMLA, Mr. Minho Kim

Suhyoon Jahng

Mr. Minho Kim, the beloved chemistry teacher, came to KMLA last winter. Mr. Kim, who is affectionately called "Myno," always tries to spark students' interest in chemistry with his lectures. Minjok Herald interviewed Mr. Kim on November 7th, in his office.



MH: Could you introduce yourself? When did you first come to KMLA?

Kim: I'm currently a chemistry teacher in KMLA. I came here last February, in 2022. I graduated university and undergraduate school here in Korea, and I am now teaching Chemistry 1 & 2, Advanced Chemistry, and Applied Chemistry Study.

MH: When you first came to KMLA in 2022, What was your first impression of KMLA?

Kim: On the first day of school, students eagerly participated in class and constantly asked questions, which didn't give up my expectations for the school. KMLA has been a school that I've longed to come as a teacher, because KMLA is well-known for its high level of education, and I wanted to discuss and share ideas with highly motivated students who have the eagerness and passion in academic studies.

MH: Is there an unforgettable student for you? If so, tell us an episode with him/her.

Kim: Well I can't say his/her name, but he was a student I met last year. He brought a research paper and wanted to learn about how to read a paper, analyze graphs, and conduct experiments. I was impressed by him delving analytically and engaging in self-directed inquiry.

MH: Wow, I wish to be a hardworking student like him. Then is there a dream of a goal you wish to accomplish while teaching at KMLA?

Kim: My dream is to publish a general chemistry book for highschool students. I've been thinking that there are a lack of books conveying general knowledge about chemistry, and I personally think it's because there aren't that many

chemistry enthusiasts. So my dream is to write high-quality and comprehensive chemistry books for high school students to easily understand.

MH: I promise to be the first reader of your book. Then what is your life motto?

Kim: My life motto is to do the best with what's given. When I was in my military service, seniors told me not to stand out as much as possible. But despite such advice, I tried my best while I was doing my military service as an administrative personnel. My work was to make PowerPoints for my seniors to use when presenting. Back then PowerPoint presentation programs were in their early stages, so I had to study on my own and learn from a well-designed PowerPoint presentation. In the end, my seniors recognized my abilities and I was able to utilize my skills in various fields such as participating in PowerPoint design contests.

MH: Many people would agree on that point. Are there any tips for students who are struggling to study chemistry?

Kim: Chemistry up to middle school is closer to rote memorization. However, high school chemistry, especially KMLA's chemistry education is different because we learn the basic principles. So I believe a deep understanding of scientific concepts is required.

MH: How did you decide to major in chemistry? What aspect of chemistry fascinated you the most?

Kim: Well, I used to be an astronomy buff. However, people around me told me that having astronomy as a profession is not a good choice. So I thought that since I was interested in pure science, I should major in chemistry. My passion for astronomy never waned, so I decided to integrate astronomy with chemistry and study astrochemistry.

MH: Any last words for KMLA students?

Kim: Hmm...I won't make eloquent statements, but to give some advice to our students, I strongly recommend students to reduce their time spent on gaming. When I was in highschool, we had self-study time like you guys do. I spent every self-study time playing Starcraft. I regret this will continue to regret all time. I could've tried things that I wanted to do before it got too late. This is why I advise students to quit games before it gets too late.



"One child, one teacher, one book, one pen can change the world."

– Malala Yousafzai

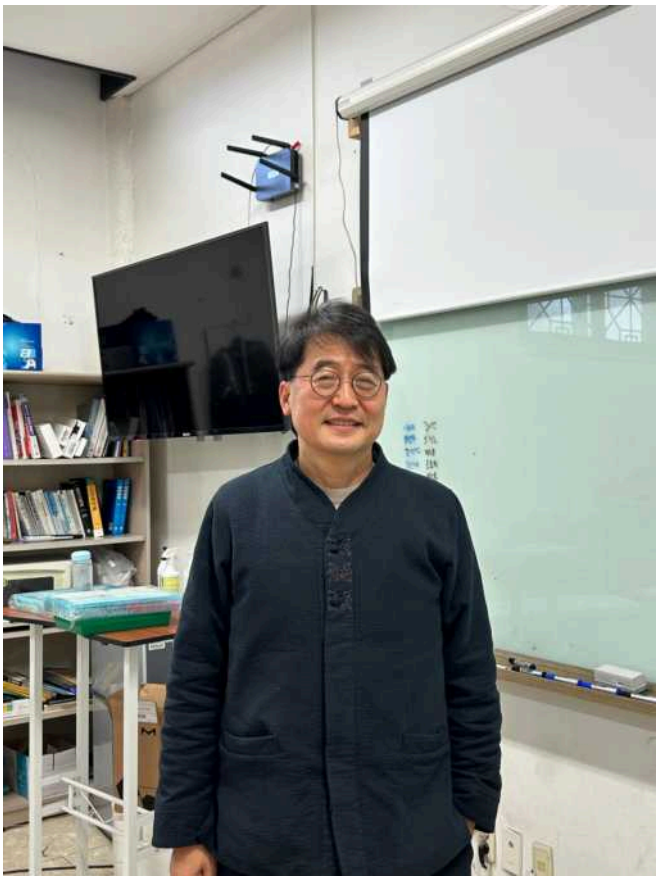
"A teacher affects eternity; he can never tell where his influence stops."

- Henry Brooks Adams

Welcome to KMLA, Mr. Dongjin Kim

Sangmin Lee

Mr. Dong-Jin Kim, the new Chemistry teacher, arrived in KMLA in the first semester of 2023. Fortunately for the students, his stay did not end as a temporary one unlike initial intentions of leaving after one semester. To introduce him, and for the KMLA family to get to know him better, Minjok Herald interviewed Mr. Kim on November 13th by visiting his office.



MH: Could you introduce yourself? What other work did you do before you came to KMLA?

Kim: I'm currently a Chemistry teacher in KMLA. I graduated university and graduate school in Korea, in the Biochemistry field. Then I went abroad to the US, where I did research for about 10 years.

Eventually I went to Africa, Kenya to be specific, and I worked in an international center that focuses on solving the food problem in the whole continent, for about 6 years. Next I moved to Tanzania where I worked as a professor.

After about 11 years spent in Africa, I returned to Korea because I was tired and needed rest. I worked as a visiting professor in KAIST for a year. I initially planned to leave for Africa soon, but figuring I needed some more rest, I worked in a biotech company in Korea for about 3 years.

When I realized that my job was to make a difference from out in the actual fields, I went back to Africa, Rwanda this time, and this was sometime around the early 2000. I worked in the National Forensic Service, dealing with DNA. I was in charge of upgrading the technology to global standards, and worked in the government.

During Covid when things weren't so easy, I returned to Korea. Coincidentally, I was notified of KMLA, and am currently teaching AP Chemistry to students here.

MH: Wow, your story is so fascinating. Considering you've worked for such a long time in Africa, you must know a lot about the situation there. How would you describe the current status of scientific fields in Africa?

Kim: It severely lacks infrastructure and government support. The only two fields that are advanced are agriculture and health, but in any other field, there is not much. Not many facilities and universities for technology and science to improve.

MH: I see, and you provided your effort in trying to improve the situation. I was also curious, how is teaching different from the work you've done in the past?

Kim: It's really hard to compare the two, I would even say meaningless because they are completely different things. The work I did in Africa was something that I had to do because I went there to make something happen. Meanwhile, teaching was something unexpected; something

completely new and fun. I would definitely say teaching is enjoyable and meaningful to me.

MH: I've taken your classes, and I can feel that you're very passionate about teaching students. On another note, who is someone that you respect, and why?

Kim: Norman Borlaug, winner of Nobel Peace prize, because he is a hero who led one of the most important revolutions in recent history. Started in the late 1960's, the Green Revolution was a crucial key to solving the food problems after the World Wars. By modifying crops and increasing yields, the entire world was able to keep food on their plates. I actually had a chance to meet him and listen to one of his lectures, and he told me he supported my work in Africa.

MH: That's amazing. I didn't even know about such an important event! What if you could meet any famous person, who would that be?

Kim: Perhaps not famous, but I'd like to meet the colleagues that I worked with in Africa again. Working there for more than 10 years, I met many nice people. They are, regardless of their capabilities or the poor conditions, very open and available to others. I received a lot of help from them, and so I'd love to get a chance to meet them again.

MH: That's very wholesome. Considering you teach Chemistry, what kind of field of study is Chemistry? How would you describe it and what's special about it?

Kim: Chemistry tries to explain the natural world in terms of what it consists of, and how different substances consist of the world. Of all the natural sciences, I think it's the way of observing the way in the most basic level. Knowing or not knowing about these kinds of things matter to everyone, whether they are into natural or human sciences, even art.

MH: I think that's something everyone should keep in mind. On a lighter note, do you have something you like to do in your leisure time, like hobbies?

Kim: Having only read research papers for my whole life, I think I want to get into reading books a lot more. I think that would be my hobby.

MH: Books! I love books as well. What's your favorite book of all time and why?

Kim: My favorite book is 'Hope for the Flowers'. I first read it in highschool, but each time I read it in my teens, 20's, and even up until now, it teaches me something new about life. It's a book I would recommend to everyone.

MH: Speaking about highschool, I'm curious what your favorite high school memory would be.

Kim: I remember hanging out with a group of friends, 6 of us. We used to study together and play baseball after school, during weekends, and during vacations. We still meet to this day.

MH: I think friend groups like that are very important, they give us a lot of support. Do you have a happy place?

Kim: Since I usually moved from place to place during my work, I always felt alone. There were some colleagues, but I worked in my own space. Coming back to Korea and to home for rest was really meaningful, so that could be my happy place. In KMLA, I usually take a walk around the grass field to take some time to think.

MH: That's going to have to be the end of this interview. Before we go, do you have any life tips you want to share with the KMLA family?

Kim: There's a saying that in 2100, the average life expectancy will go up to 120. What I'm trying to say is, there's still a very long life ahead of students. The three years in highschool as well as university might seem like everything right now. But always remember, life is much more than that, and we should all try to live our best every day.





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Cultural Exchange Flourishes as KMLA and Raffles Institution Collaborate



Daeun Song

During the Covid-era cross-cultural events involving visitors to KMLA more-or-less ceased to exist, but we've recently re-engaged with our Singaporian sister-school as Raffles Institution returned to take part in our exchange program from September 13th to the 18th. The experience was both eye-opening and friendship-forging, leading to a shared understanding of the two different educational settings.

The Raffles students arrived in Korea for a week-long stay at KMLA. During their visit, they had the opportunity to observe KMLA's classes and join everything from morning exercise to Honjeong.

To help Raffles students adapt, students were paired with KMLA students who acted proudly as guides providing insights into daily life, helping Raffles students acclimate.

After a week at KMLA, students took their Raffles counterparts on a tour of Seoul. This outing created lasting memories of Korea as they said their goodbyes on Sunday night.

To gain a better understanding of the Raffles students' experiences, MH conducted an interview with two students: Jovian and Prawin.

MH: What inspired your decision to visit KMLA?

Jovian: I wanted to experience life in a Korean school, especially one as well-regarded as KMLA.

Prawin: Following further research, I selected South Korea, specifically KMLA, as I was intrigued by the range of interesting club activities and academic subjects it offers, as well as the vastly different lifestyle students lead in KMLA as compared to Raffles Institution - thus motivating me to apply for the cultural exchange program with KMLA, to step out of my comfort zone to undergo the KMLA experience.

MH: What were your expectations about KMLA before your visit?

Jovian: To be honest, I didn't have many expectations; I just came with an open mind to experience a new school environment.

Prawin: The rustic scenery in which the school setting is placed, and the traditional architecture present in educational buildings were some traits I expected to observe in KMLA. Next, I thought students would be rather shy and unwilling to interact with my fellow Raffles students and myself, because of cultural differences and possible language barriers.

MH: Can you share the differences and similarities between your expectations and the reality at KMLA?

Jovian: The school was much larger than I expected, and the students were very friendly. Additionally, the academic workload at KMLA was noticeably heavier compared to that of Singaporean students.

Prawin: The sights, sounds, and smells of KMLA far exceeded my expectations, and I truly enjoyed every moment of my stay here - due to the picturesque views, and intricate integration of nature into the school environment. The genuine hospitality and amiability of KMLA students pleasantly surprised me, as they patiently answered my questions about the school environment, and also actively engaged in conversations with me.

MH: Reflecting on your time at KMLA, what was your most cherished memory, and why?

Jovian: The most memorable moment was the barbecue gathering. Raffles and KMLA students had heartfelt conversations, and the food was delicious.

Prawin: Barbecue session. It was my first time experiencing barbecue in a school setting, as in Raffles Institution, we lack such facilities. It was truly a memorable moment for me as well, as I got to interact, understand more about their personalities, and make valuable friendships with not only my KMLA buddies but also other students as well.

MH: What are some key similarities and differences you noticed between KMLA and Raffles?

Jovian: We found common ground in the spacious campuses, dedicated teachers, motivated students, and shared academic commitments. Differences included the location, with KMLA on a mountain and Raffles in an urban area. Also, KMLA operates as a full boarding school, which is different from our experience at Raffles.

Prawin: The physical setting is vastly different, with a lovely intertwining of nature and learning in KMLA as compared to an urbanized environment in Raffles. Similarities in academic learning are indeed present - the breadth and depth of concepts in common subjects are comparable. However, they still possess their own individualistic features - in KMLA, learning takes place till 12 am while in Raffles till about 4 pm, and differs depending on the day. There is also a wide range of club activities in both Raffles and KMLA; however, students in KMLA take up a significantly higher number as opposed to Raffles students, who instead select 1-2 and dedicate their time solely to them. The student culture is largely similar as well - friendly, driven by various passions and interests, and academically curious.

MH: Could you tell us about your final day with your KMLA friends?

Jovian: Our last day was a lot of fun. Most of us paired up with buddies who knew the area well, so we explored the best spots in Jamsil. Having more time to explore would have been great!

Prawin: I thoroughly enjoyed myself, as I got to know more about my buddy through spending a considerable portion of the day with her - eating, walking, and sightseeing. I was able to visit famous landmarks in Jamsil, such as the Seoul Sky and Seokchon Lake! We also made matching bracelets, which was a fun, amusing experience. Overall, it was truly an unforgettable, and fulfilling day!

MH: In summary, what were your overall impressions of Korea and KMLA?

Jovian: I enjoyed experiencing Korean culture and found Koreans to be very friendly. KMLA was a great experience, and I appreciated how the teachers involved us in their classes. Perhaps more opportunities to join classes with KMLA students would have enhanced our experience.

Prawin: I believe that Korea and KMLA both have strong cultural and historical roots, safeguarding and preserving them through their people, food, places, architecture, and traditions. It does so with a light touch of modernity as well, catering to younger generations and tourists alike.

Additionally, authentic Korean food truly exposed my tastebuds to a diverse range of flavors that I had never experienced before and motivated me to try out more Korean traditional cuisines and other aspects of culture.

MH: Is there a message you'd like to convey to your matched friends and the KMLA students?

Jovian: Thank you so much for being wonderful hosts! We truly enjoyed the KMLA experience and greatly appreciate it. You are welcome to visit Singapore anytime!

Prawin: Thank you to everyone who interacted with me, and helped me out throughout my stay at KMLA! You guys are very upbeat, funny, and pleasant to talk to, and it made my stay way more delightful. To my buddies, Haeun Lee and Minseo Kang, thank you for always being cheerful, lively and guiding me around the school. And really thanks for all the snacks and gifts you gave me, I truly appreciate all the time and effort you guys put in!!



Cultivating Innovation: The Evolution of KMLA's Workspace as a Hub of Creative Exploration

Daeun Song

On October 31st, Mr. Mok-hee Jeon delivered a captivating presentation to students, unveiling the remarkable transformation of KMLA's new workspace, located in the Golf Range building. Formerly in a dilapidated state, the workspace has undergone a significant overhaul, now serving as a dynamic hub where students can freely nurture their creative pursuits. Buz Aerospace, an integrated project team composed of mostly physics students, was instrumental in convincing KMLA of the need for such a facility, which has become known among students as "The KMLA Forge."

During the presentation, Mr. Jeon provided details about the diverse array of cutting-edge machinery available for student use, and kindly agreed to our follow-up interview.



MH: What motivated the creation of this workspace?

Mr. Jeon: Our makerspace was conceived as a vital support system for KMLA students to actualize their creative visions using state-of-the-art digital equipment, with a keen focus on preparing them for the challenges of the Fourth Industrial Revolution. We sought to foster interdisciplinary learning endeavors that harmonize with the school's educational philosophy.

MH: What were the pivotal considerations during the setup?

Mr. Jeon: Our foremost priorities revolved around addressing the building's previous insulation issues, which resulted in condensation and posed seasonal challenges, particularly during winter. Equally crucial was the creation of a stimulating and inviting environment, prompting close collaboration with the design team to tackle these concerns effectively.

MH: How is the management of the makerspace structured?

Mr. Jeon: The management approach encompasses two key dimensions. Firstly, we have the "Users and Hours" system, permitting a maximum of four teams with up to 10 members each, per semester, under the guidance of the interdisciplinary project teacher. Additionally, students who have made advanced reservations can access the makerspace during designated time slots on specified days.

Secondly, we enforce strict "Conditions for Use," mandating that students undergo safety training before utilizing the equipment they have reserved. Any breaches of safety protocols, failure to clean up after use, or non-compliance with the teacher's instructions can result in warnings and restrictions on usage.

MH: What transformations or impacts do you envision stemming from student activities within the workspace?

Mr. Jeon: I fervently hope that the makerspace will serve as an empowering catalyst, enabling students to transform creative concepts into tangible realities. I am eager to witness their contentment and satisfaction as they harness the full potential of the available equipment.

MH: Which specific equipment do you anticipate students will use most?

Mr. Jeon: Anticipated favorites among students are likely to include the 3D Printer, Plotter, and Table Saw.





MH: What unique features render the workspace particularly intriguing?

Mr. Jeon: Notably, the most captivating elements encompass the Laser Cutting machine, macLatex Printer, and the 5-axis CNC Milling (PocketNC).

MH: Do you have any words of guidance for students intending to utilize the workspace, or any additional message?

Mr. Jeon: I encourage students to proactively seek guidance in case of any queries regarding the workspace or its equipment. Our earnest desire is for this well-equipped facility to be utilized to its fullest potential. It is imperative for every student to undergo mandatory safety training for each specific piece of equipment, in addition to ensuring that all machinery is left in its original state post-usage. Furthermore, strict adherence to the designated time slots is important.

Subsequent to the insightful interview, Minjok Herald embraced the opportunity to explore the workspace at Mr. Jeon's suggestion. Impressively, the workspace exudes a sense of orderliness and efficiency, standing in contrast to its previous neglected state. The substantial investment of over 700 million won, donated by the KCC, is evidently justified. Mr. Jeon meticulously described the functionalities of each machine, underscoring their quality. His aspiration to eliminate any constraints on students' creative potential is palpable. Notably, a myriad of diverse projects are already in progress, ranging from the creation of intricate company logos using 3D printers to the crafting of bespoke wooden items with the aid of the laser cutter.

Beyond the impressive array of machinery, safety measures are also fully in place, including the incorporation of a 'sawstop' safety feature, which automatically halts sawing upon detecting contact with fingers, alongside the installation of effective ventilation fans, underscoring the importance placed on ensuring student safety.

The visit to the workspace provided a glimpse into Mr. Mok-hee Jeon's unwavering dedication and passion. In conclusion, Mr. Jeon expressed his heartfelt desire for students to actively embrace the workspace as a catalyst for materializing their creative aspirations, fostering the birth of truly exceptional projects.



Go Visit Instagram @buz_aerospace for more detailed information



The Grand Minsaeum Symphony: A Yearlong Crescendo of Excellence Unveiled in a Majestic Concert

Sangmin Lee

Minsaeum is a distinguished music event that stands as a symbol of the collective musical prowess of the students in KMLA. This esteemed occasion serves as a showcase where accomplished groups unveil the results of their year-long dedication to musical perfection. From the grandeur of orchestral compositions to the compelling performances of various bands and the beauty of Korean traditional music, Minsaeum captivates all that listen. Dive into the full experience of Minsaeum, from the preparation to the outcome.

The Orchestra Camps

The history of KMLA's two orchestras is undoubtedly one of the longest among all existing clubs. Both were established over a decade ago: KMLA Orchestra for Western music and Minjok Orchestra for a fusion of Western and traditional Korean styles.

The summer camp has been the main activity of both orchestras since formation, and endears as an essential tradition to finish the Minsaeum successfully. KMLA Orchestra and Minjok Orchestra spend this precious

weekend outside the school, focusing only on music and practice. This year, the camp was from August 19th to 20th at Welli Hilli Park, a ski resort near KMLA.

Predictably, the schedules of both orchestras are very similar. After they arrive at their camps, it's a continuous mixture of individual part practices and ensembles. Except for brief breaks and meal times, every member dedicates their time to perfecting their parts. Each group has professional instructors to give them lessons, and a chief conductor guides them through ensemble sessions. During their two-day camp, their instruments are in hand for over 15 hours.

Reflections of the students who joined the summer camp vary, but many feel ambivalent towards this intensive 48-hour music-indulged program. Many enjoy practicing, but the lack of break times drains their energy.

One 28th waver from KMLA Orchestra shared, "I was engrossed in music for the first time in a while. My fingers got calloused, and I felt proud because I noticed myself improving and fixing my problems. But I seriously wanted more time to rest and sleep. It was nice to stay out of school, but I hoped we would also look around the resort a little. The atmosphere was slightly demanding, too, which I understood but didn't particularly enjoy."

Members of Minjok Orchestra gave their opinions as well. One recalled, "I got meaningful feedback from a real expert in the field, so it was better than when we rehearsed alone. I was also thrilled when the song started to meld into one. I realized the value of performing in an orchestra. Some people complained about harsh schedules, but I personally liked it." Another student commented, "It was simultaneously

fun and painful. I could feel myself going into a trance after a while."

When reflecting on the most memorable experiences during the camp, many singled out their ensemble sessions. Yun-jin Lee, a 28th waver in Minjok Orchestra shared, "The last ensemble rehearsal was unforgettable. At first, I felt hopeless because I'd never played two of the songs on the list, and one was fast. But we could complete the piece after pouring our efforts in for two days. I was overwhelmed when teachers and parents clapped for us at the final rehearsal of the camp."



The Rehearsal

Preceding the actual Minsaeum event, students convened for a crucial rehearsal, twice. The first was in the school gym, debuting their performances before their peers for the first time. While the conditions weren't perfect, students could not stop applauding at the outstanding performances their peers had prepared.

The day before the actual event, the second and final rehearsal took place, at the Hoengseong-gun Culture and Arts Center. The rehearsal space hummed with a blend of anticipation and a hint of apprehension as each ensemble assumed the spotlight. Ranging from the spirited sounds of the bands to the refined orchestral compositions and the culturally rich Korean traditional music, the rehearsal offered a comprehensive preview of the diverse musical palette awaiting the audience.

As the participants presented their works, praises and applause filled the air, and an atmosphere of mutual support and shared enthusiasm permeated the room, setting the tone for an impending Minsaeum characterized by both artistic brilliance and collaborative spirit.



The Day of the Minsaeum

On November 17th, the enchanting melodies and passionate energy filled the halls of Hoengseong-gun Culture and Arts Center, marking a defining day to showcase the culmination of six months of dedicated effort by students, including the rigorous five-hour rehearsal the previous day.
The event kicked off with 'Dae-chwi-ta', a club specializing



in Korean traditional classical music. Their symbolic slogan, enthusiastically shouting "Myeong guem ilha ~ Dae~ chwi-ta~," captivated the audience's attention. Following their performance, 2nd graders, skilled in 'gayageum' presented a captivating rendition of "Under the Sea" from The Little Mermaid, adorned in beautiful hanbok attire. The collaboration between 1st graders of the gayageum class and

2nd graders of the daegeum class in a duet showcased the emotion of 'profound love' with harmonious perfection.

The heartfelt chorus by parents added a deeper layer to the performance, portraying the genuine love of mothers for their children. The concert's first part concluded with two orchestras – the Western-instrumental KMLA Orchestra, delivering a magnificent impact, and the Minjok Orchestra, a fusion of Korean traditional and Western instruments, showcasing the charm of fusion music.



Following a break, the second part of the concert began with 'Samuchim,' a club specializing in Korean traditional percussion quartet. The beats of drums, janggus, kkwaenggwaris, and jings resonated, creating a thrilling rhythm that resonated in the hearts of the audience.

The atmosphere in the second half differed significantly from the first, with performances more interactive and engaging for the audience. 'Rhyme Factory' presented a well-blended harmony of sincere lyrics and astonishing dances, while each band showcased its unique color, drawing the audience fully into their world. The performances by teacher bands highlighted the strong bond between teachers and students at KMLA.

The musical club "The Scene" added a touch of cuteness with their performance of "La La Land," and the event concluded with the heartfelt song "One Candle" by students, leaving a lasting impression on teachers.

This year's Minjok Music Festival provided students with the opportunity to reveal their hidden talents. It served as a source of positive energy for teachers, parents, and students alike, fostering a sense of unity under the enchanting power of music. The delightful memories created during this festival will linger in the hearts of students until their graduation, becoming an integral part of their KMLA experience. A sincere thank you to all who contributed to making this festival a resounding success.

Club Spotlight

Minjok Orchestra



MH: Please explain your club or organization briefly.
Minjok Orchestra is a fusion orchestra that plays the harmony of traditional Korean and Western instruments. Therefore, various traditional Korean instruments such as gayageum, daegeum, janggu, buk, kkwaenggwari, and haegeum, as well as more familiar Western orchestra instruments like violin, piano, cello, clarinet, and flute, play music together. Due to the variety of instruments and a large number of members responsible for them, Minjok Orchestra is the largest club at KMLA and stands out as one of the school's representative clubs, presenting distinctive music on the KMLA stage every year.

MH: What do you perform on stage on the day of the Minsaeum and how did you come to choose them?
In Minsaeum this year in 2023, our performance begins dynamically and energetically with the rendition of the traditional melody "Arirang," transformed into 'Arirang Rhapsody,' revealing the unique beauty of Korean music. "Fly to the Sky" combines the mellifluous sounds of Western instruments and piano with the lively tunes of traditional

Korean instruments such as kkwaenggwari, janggu, gayageum, daegeum, and daegeum, creating a cheerful yet dreamy musical atmosphere. Finally, the performance concludes with the majestic and special charm of Shin Hae-chul's "To You," blending both Korean and Western instruments.

MH: What did you do specifically during the camp?
During the camp, we practiced more intensively for a longer period than regular rehearsals during the semester. We began full-fledged ensemble rehearsals, and with the help of various instrument specialists working with the arranger, we had dedicated sessions for section rehearsals and full ensemble rehearsals to enhance the completeness of the piece.

MH: What was the hardest thing about preparing for the Minsaeum?
As the conductor and club president, the most challenging aspect of preparing for the Minsaeum was undoubtedly coordinating with the 50 members. With members from various classes and majors, it was not easy to make decisions that satisfied everyone, from setting practice schedules to coordinating the content of the performance.

MH: Tell us your overall thoughts on the performance.
I believe the performance at the Minsaeum was possible because each club member worked hard in their assigned roles. I am truly grateful for the dedication of all members who invested a lot of time in Minjok Orchestra activities over the year, practicing and preparing. In the end, it was satisfying to put on a performance that everyone was pleased with.

Student Choir



MH: Please explain your club or organization briefly.
As our name shows, we are a choir at KMLA consisting of 28th wavers interpreting and singing songs with rich harmonies and tones with approximately 40 people.

MH: What do you perform on stage on the day of the Minsaeum and how did you come to choose them?
We sang Rick Astley's globally famous and widely memed song "Never Gonna Give You Up," which is lively and delightful. Also we've performed G.o,d's "One Candle," which is fitting to express the accumulated confusion, sadness, and the intricate mix of emotions such as anticipation for the second year in KMLA.

MH: What was the hardest thing about preparing for the Minsaeum?
While operating the choir, there were several challenging aspects, but one of the most difficult parts was choosing the songs for the Minjok Music Festival. We pondered a lot about selecting a meaningful song that both the audience and we could enjoy. In the end, since the Minjok Music Festival marks the end of the school year at KMLA, we chose a song that reflects the profound emotions of "A Year at KMLA."

MH: Tell us your overall thoughts on the performance.
At the Minjok Music Festival, It was meaningful that we poured all our hearts that we prepared. I was deeply moved by the enthusiasm of the audience and their appreciation for our performance, especially Ms. Hwang So-hee teacher, who watched our performance and shed tears. Thank you so much!

KMLA Orchestra

MH: Hello! Before we start, please briefly introduce you and your club.
Hello, I'm Minjoon Oh, the 27th waver, and the conductor of KMLA Orchestra. KMLA Orchestra consists of the best musicians on campus, specializing in classical orchestral music.

MH: What do you perform on stage on the day of the Minsaeum and how did you come to choose them?

For this year's Minsaeum, KMLA Orchestra performed Sunrise from Also sprach Zarathustra, Waltz of Flowers from The Nutcracker, and Pomp and Circumstance Military Marches Op. 39. We wanted to show the story of our orchestra. First, we decided to perform Sunrise from Also sprach Zarathustra to start off grandly.

The next song, Waltz of Flowers from The Nutcracker, is played at the dreamlike scene where all characters and flowers dance together. We thought that Minsaeum was a place for all members and the audience to come together and enjoy at the end of the year, so Waltz of Flowers was the perfect choice for it. This song has its own elegant mood, and I believe our members showed the mood well in their performance.

The last song, Pomp and Circumstance Military Marches Op. 39, is the most well-known song of the English composer Edward Elgar. This year, our school has gone through so many incidents. We were in the recovering stage of COVID-19, and it was a stressful year for so many people in and out of our school. We wished people listening to our music could cope with these hardships and move forwards towards next year.

MH: What did you focus on during the camp and how big of a difference did it make?

During the two days, we split into parts depending on our instruments and practice intensively and also practice ensemble performance. Over the two days, we get closer to each other and enhance our skills significantly. Usually most of the members are busy doing their academic work. However, in summer camps, members get to fully focus only on the performance with enough time and get active feedback from professional orchestra performers.

MH: What was the hardest thing about preparing for the Minsaeum?

You might think that the hardest thing about preparing for the Minsaeum could be studying the full score, but the most difficult part was arranging our practice times. We, as students, should prioritize academics over anything else, so there is bound to be a lack of practice time. Since there were students who participated in more than one club for the Minsaeum, it was difficult to consider everyone's schedule and arrange the orchestra's practice time. Unlike last year, where I only had to think about my schedule, this year, as a composer, I was able to learn how to take into account others' point of views.



MH: Tell us your overall thoughts on the performance.

I believe it would've been impossible to present such a successful performance without countless help and support through the year. We performed as much as we poured in hard work, and illuminated the Minsaeum from our place as KMLA Orchestra. I want to thank the part leaders who have helped selecting the songs and the overall practice, vice conductor and concertmaster who have supported me the most, and lastly every member who have shown trust and follow our tough schedule. It was a great opportunity to learn many things, and I am proud of everyone!



Band Union: Balsik

MH: Hello! Before we start, please explain your club briefly.

Hello, we are Balalhan Shikhye! Our club, in short, Balsik, was created with ambitious aspirations based on the spirit of preferring rock to pop, valuing genuine talent over cool looks, and loving creative renditions over simple instrumental accompaniments.

MH: What do you perform on stage on the day of the Minsaeum and how did you come to choose them?

We played 'Isn't It Good?' by YUDABIN BAND. The original songwriter is Crying Nut. We thought that we could deliver the lively spirit expressed only by a newly formed band and the solace through heartwarming lyrics by playing this song.

MH: What was special about being the only band made up of 28th Wavers?

First, the biggest advantage is that we are relatively free. Unlike other bands that should consider the high expectations of the audience, Balsik, as a newly formed band, was able to choose the overall mood of the band and the performance arrangement.

Second, the members of Balsik were scouted, not chosen through an audition, based on their skills and unique musical features. So members who have experienced various genres including metal, ballad, jazz, and rock are involved in this creative musical activity. People from different backgrounds got together in Balsik--Vocalist Minju Kim and Sehyun Lee, keyboardist Jaehun Lee, bassist Jiho Moon and Minzee Choe, and lastly the drummer Geonwoo Park. Our members share diverse ideas and musical insights to create a better stage.

MH: What was the hardest thing about preparing for the Minsaeum?

The difficulties that we encountered were predestined. Since we weren't a regular band, we couldn't practice in the band practice room until we passed the audition. I vividly remember the time when we had to practice drums with a chair and practice the keyboard just by tapping them on a desk. It was also mentally challenging. We felt the pressure that we had to be recognized by the audience. Looking back, it seems that we had the obsession to prove that we were able, and confident, to perform for the entire three minutes.

We were able to overcome these challenges thanks to the solid support and encouragement of teachers, seniors, and our friends.

Minsaeum to KMLA

Minsaeum stands as a testament to the vibrant tapestry of musical creativity and dedication within our student community. As we dive deeper into the performances that grace the stage, it becomes evident that Minsaeum is more than just a showcase; it's a celebration of shared passion, collaboration, and the transformative power of music. Each note played, every beat, and every harmonious blend is a testament to the hard work and commitment of the students who pour their hearts into their performances.

Until next year's crescendo, let the harmonies of Minsaeum continue to resonate within our hearts, reminding us of the enduring power of artistic expression and the joy that comes from coming together to celebrate our shared love for music.





Saying Farewell to the 26th Wavers and Celebrating Their New Start

Daeun Song

It is a natural phenomenon to experience a moment of "end" once we initiate a beginning. After witnessing the blossoms three times, the blue sky of summer, the red-colored leaves, and the snowy winter, the final day of goodbyes has come.

The last three years in KMLA will be memorable to 26th wavers whether they had good memories or not. They have also made fond memories with 27th and 28th wavers, being good mentors throughout the KMLA journey, being reliable support in tough times, and becoming friends to share all sorts of emotions with.

What would 26th wavers feel upon leaving the school and starting anew? Minjok Herald conducted an interview with 26th waver Hwang Eun Gyeol, to understand what the three years in KMLA mean to them.

MH: As you are about to graduate, how do you feel?
Hwang: Actually, I still can't believe that I am graduating. The fact that I spent three years in this school and now become an adult is hard to believe. It feels like I'm just taking a long break. However, I'm glad that I no longer have to do morning exercise.

MH: How was your life at KMLA for the past 3 years?
Hwang: It was really tough. It is true that everyone goes through difficulties, but there were moments when it was excessively difficult that I couldn't think of anything in a positive way.
As you know, the school has a lot of incidents and being in such an environment where you experience both success and failure makes continuous struggles. But looking back, every moment that I spent in this school seems beautiful and enjoyable.

MH: What is your most memorable experience at KMLA?
Hwang: I had many special memories, but to pick one, it would be preparing for the Music festival in my first grade. I was in the club "Samuchim" and prepared for the performance. "Samuchim" wasn't just a simple club activity for me. It taught me to enjoy my youth! Though it wasn't any benefit for my college entrance, practicing every day was genuinely enjoyable. Learning from great seniors and trying to be better was a precious experience that I will never forget.

MH: Do you have any significant episodes at KMLA?
Hwang: Well, In the second semester of my second year, my roommates and I decided to find a shortcut on hiking for the morning exercise. My roommates and I analyzed a mountain map made by Mr. Ganse and satellite images of the school surroundings. The next day, we woke up a bit late and decided to try an unverified shortcut. It turned out to be a muddy and challenging mountain path, and we ended up with muddy shoes and socks. We couldn't make it to the morning exercise on time and spent our spare time in the morning washing our shoes and socks. Later, we found out there were no shortcuts.

MH: What activities do you want to do after graduation?
Hwang: What I wanted to do the most was drink with friends!(Laughs). So, as soon as I became an adult, I actively made plans to meet up with friends and enjoy drinks. Apart from that, I wanted to read books and make money! Especially by trying GLPS. I've always liked reading books, but during my time at KMLA, I couldn't find time to read. So, I want to take the opportunity to read the books. I've heard great memories from seniors who participated in GLPS before, and I wanted to have a chance for it.

Fortunately, it happened to be available this winter! I'm really excited to meet many great seniors. Also, I heard that school pays quite well for being a graduate participant! Other than these, I want to enjoy my freshman life in college!

MH: Do you have any words for your 26th wavers?
Hwang: Hello, everyone! Haha, I'm Eun Gyeol. It feels like we entered this school on a day when snow was falling heavily, and it's hard to believe we're already graduating. You've all worked really hard for the past three years! Especially to those who suffered with a loud and talkative kid like me, thank you, love you, and sorry! Especially to those who were by my side, liked me, and even those who disliked me! Thank you so much. Thanks to you, I feel like I became a somewhat decent person. Our 26th wavers had a lot of kind people, and it always felt like a bright and cheerful atmosphere. Every day of my three years at KMLA was enjoyable. Now we will take a new step toward the world and experience new things... Congratulations on your graduation, and I sincerely hope that when we meet again by chance, we can greet each other warmly. Finally, everyone, congratulations on graduating!

MH: Do you have any words for the new 29th wavers and the 27th, 28th wavers?
Hwang: I want to tell them that it's okay to fail and be imperfect. There might be a lot of pressure to always do well, but it's okay to be a bit inexperienced and awkward. The quizzes in front of you may seem important now, and it might feel like life is over if we fail once, but that's not true. I think it is fine to enjoy the process while being a bit clumsy. Trying various activities wholeheartedly, investing time and effort like a fool, and enjoying school life with friends, even if it means being a bit silly. Failure can become an important asset as you gain more experience. While experiencing failure can be painful and depressing, it can make you more mature and a better person. Accept everything as a learning opportunity. When you realize this, failure is no longer scary, and trying things becomes an opportunity for growth. I hope all wavers to not be afraid of failure, challenge themselves, and enjoy life even if they are a bit inexperienced.

MH: Do you have any words for the teachers who guided you at KMLA?
Hwang: Hello, teachers! This is Eun Gyeol from the 26th wave :) Whenever I saw KMLA teachers, I often imagined what kind of adult I would become. You teachers were role models for me. Thanks to your teachings, my thinking has expanded significantly. The lessons I learned from you were not just about widening my knowledge but also about attitudes towards life and ways of thinking. Recently, seeing your love for the school was truly admirable. I am thankful for instilling in me the desire to grow into a wonderful adult like you and for teaching us not only knowledge but also something beyond that. Expressing gratitude to teachers always feels insufficient, but I sincerely appreciate everything. I will strive to become a great adult like you and pass on the lessons learned from you to the next generation, influencing the world positively. Thank you always, and I love you! I will visit the school when I get a chance. Stay healthy:)

It will be somehow sad to face the farewell with the school and people to whom we are attached. However, we all know the memories will always remain and this is not the end of the story for the 26th wavers. Now, they will step into a new world, brightening it with their own colors. And we, the so-called "KMLA family" will always support them on this new path.

"Great job, everyone. Goodbye, 26th wavers!"



“Farewell, Memory” by Sangmin Lee



Mangyeong Literary Competition English 1st Place

In an effort to promote creative writing at KMLA, the Minjok Herald proudly shares the winning English entry of the school's 28th annual Mangyeong Literary Competition, won by 28th waver, Sangmin Lee. With only the picture above as a prompt, contestants are invited to write anything they want within a two-hour period. Enjoy this romantic short story!

Again, there he was. Same place, same clothes, same person. Her soft hands in his, eyes staring at each other, and their souls together. He could see her lips moving, creating the same sounds that had been haunting him in his nostalgic nightmare, for the last 30 years.

"I don't think we can be together anymore ." He couldn't hear the last word, but it was undoubtedly his name, which he had forgotten years ago.

Her name was Jane. When they had first met, she was staring at a painting on the wall, in a museum somewhere in Paris. Among others who passed by each painting quickly, she was standing still. Contrary to the painting, which was of mediocre quality, her gaze was enchanting; it was as if the painting was being consumed, and he knew immediately that she had been coming to the same place, at least for years.

"It's a very nice painting," he approached her, intrigued by his observations. For a few seconds, she seemed to have missed his words completely.

"It was painted by my father. Last one he ever did." She was still staring at the painting.

"Ah."

'Awkward,' he thought. He took a chance to admire the details, which weren't much. It was a building; perhaps a theater, though he couldn't tell by the crude details. On the top it read, 'GRANADA'.

"He always said he wanted to bring me there." Her voice, unlike before, was full of emotion. "It's amazing, isn't it? How someone can paint something with such detail, even.. "

"Even?"

"Nothing. Just, I want to understand what kind of person he was."

Feeling like he was intruding personal territory, he excused himself after an awkward farewell.

The next day, she was there. Then the next. Eventually, it became part of his life; standing beside her and looking at the painting after work. Sometimes for a few minutes, and sometimes for hours. They rarely exchanged words, but he felt that he understood her more and more as he joined her every day.

Then, one day, an unexpected invitation broke the silence.

"Want to come and see?" It was the first time she had taken her eyes off of the painting, and as he stared into her brown irises, he was unable to move. An eon of depth, of sadness; he could not begin to fathom how much pain she must have been through.

After the moment had passed, he could finally comprehend the question and answered, "See? See what? Or where?"

"My work. I also paint, you know."

'I didn't know,' he thought. "I would love to."

They walked the streets, took the subway, and arrived at a small house just outside the city. The house was lovely; flowers in the garden, nice interior, and dozens of paintings decorating the walls. Something, though, was missing. The feeling of a 'home', he could only phrase, some type of soul.

"Are these all yours?" he said, pointing at the art.

"Some. Some are my father's." They continued through the house, when a voice called out.

"January? Is that you?" It was the voice of an old man, Jane's father.

"I thought.." he swallowed his words. 'I thought your father had passed away.'

"My father. He suffers from loss of memory. He can't remember much. Only my name." The woman, now seemingly named January, said.

After tending to her father, she went on to showcase her works. The themes of the art varied, but they all had the same feeling to them.

Emptiness.

From that day on, their relationship grew deeper. It was as if they understood each other, not just as lovers, but as fellow human beings. They fulfilled each other; what she lacked, he had; what he lacked, she had. Eventually they bought the painting in the museum, which was luckily but unfortunately cheap, and they could sit at home for hours, both captivated by the art.

One day, like any other day, he came home from work. Jane, now, was undoubtedly in front of the painting.

"Wanna go get the groceries?" she said from the living room.

An annoyed expression on her face greeted his return.

"Love, you forgot the carrots. And the... " she listed several things. "Did you forg.." she stopped, her face showing absolute terror. "Do you forget?"

Doubt turned into fear, then rejection, then acceptance. He was suffering from the same illness as Jane's father, as told by the doctor. Unable to process the information, they spent a day apart, and for the first time in many years the painting was left abandoned.

The next day, she approached him. "Let's go somewhere. A trip. I've.. I've always wanted to take you there."

In front of the theater they were. The place was more familiar than even their homes, or any place on the planet. A single light post illuminating the streets, along with a dim light from the entrance. The sign, 'GRANADA', flickered. It was late at night, no others to be seen. They were standing across the street, and he suddenly realized that they were standing exactly where the painter must have been standing when he had painted. They were on the exact spot Jane's father had been in however many years ago.

She held his hands, and he held hers. They looked each other in the eyes.

Jane's lips opened...

After their departure, he started having nightmares. It almost killed him every night, but he craved for night time to come, because it was his only source of connection. In the real world, everything was confusing; he couldn't understand why strangers were helping him, where he was, who he was.

Every night, however, he seemed to lose a memory in his dreams. The time he had first learned to paint, with Jane teaching, he forgot. The time he almost dropped a painting, "the" painting, he also forgot. The memories disappeared one by one from his dreams until only one remained.

And tonight he was in it again. He had to stand through the pain of hearing Jane's voice, forming the most heart-wrenching sentences that destroyed his soul.

"I, I see him in you, my father. And I'm sorry, I really am, , but I cannot, cannot go through this again. You slowly losing our memories, until only a name is left... I know I shouldn't do this to you, , but.." Tears fell from her eyes, as well as his. They were looking into each other's eyes, and so they understood, they knew better than anyone... and he understood. He understood what he had to say. She also knew, and she didn't want him to say it, but also needed him to say it.

"It's.. It's okay. I.." he paused, until the lump in his throat disappeared. His body was trying to stop him from saying it, as he was denying his very being. "I'll be fine. And I'll always love you. I love you, January."

The moment before his dream ended, he somehow knew that this was the last time he would ever dream. He said farewell to his past, his lover, the sweet melancholy of a dream, and woke up to the face of an old woman, staring ever so lovingly and painfully into his eyes.

Dear KMLAians,

I hope this letter finds you in a state of mild panic and high caffeine intake. As we approach the halfway point of this semester, I want to take a moment to remind you of just how incredible you all are. Your journey through education and your dreams is like watching a hilarious sitcom with unexpected plot twists, and I must say, I'm a dedicated fan of your show.

Exams can sometimes feel like a challenging obstacle course, a bit like trying to navigate a crowded cafeteria during lunchtime rush, but fear not - you have what it takes to finish the course. You're not just capable and intelligent, you're also remarkably resourceful when it comes to finding the best places to study, whether it's Myeonhak-sil or a secret corner of the cafeteria.

In these moments of preparation and self-discovery, I encourage you to:
Reflect on Your Journey: Take a break from your marathon study sessions and reflect on how far you've come since the beginning of the semester, or even since that fateful day you set foot in this school. Acknowledge your accomplishments and remember that each step you've taken has brought you closer to your goals.
Connect with Others: Despite the endless piles of textbooks and energy drinks, remember you're not alone in this academic rollercoaster. Your fellow students are here to support you, even if they occasionally swipe your favorite study spot. Support, connect, encourage, and share snacks with them. You might just make lifelong friends.

Believe in Yourself: Self-belief is crucial, especially when you're navigating the minefield of midterms. Trust in your abilities and potential, and remember that you have the power to conquer any challenge you set your mind to. The only limits that exist are the ones you put upon yourself.

As you start this midterm adventure, remember that success is not solely measured by grades. It's about the knowledge you gain, the unforgettable experiences you accumulate, and the person you become along the way. Each of you has a unique journey, and your path to success may involve a few detours, plot twists and that's perfectly normal.

Believe in yourselves, stay resilient, and remember that we, along with your teachers, friends have faith in you. Never give up, and keep reaching for the stars - and maybe a fresh can of Monster energy drink. You are the future, and I have no doubt that your future is incredibly bright, just like the chargeable stands on your desk at 1 AM.

With unwavering support, **The Minjok Herald News Department**



Editorial

Barack Obama says, "We did not come to fear the future. We came here to shape it."
There are numerous times in our lives when we think change is impossible. No matter what we do, the world stays the same, and it is not worth trying to make a difference. Many doubt about ideals and pursuits as they face these neglections. Nonetheless, the students of KMLA do not forget the most basic principle to drive a change. The failures of the past are not relevant to the success of the future. The fear cannot outwin persistent tries. With the utmost sincerity to our resilient community, the crew of the Minjok Herald stands up to shape the future we want once more. Through covering the art facilities of KMLA, the student council, lost possessions, an integrated project, and eye-drawing interviews with the KMLA alumni, you, the avid reader, will hopefully find the courage to shape the future.

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I Have a Dream: "Now You See Me!", an Integrated Project Team



Jeonggyeom Kuk

The reality of KMLA's facilities for disabled people. Really a school for all?

"I have a dream that one day this nation will rise up and live out the true meaning of its creed: *"We hold these truths to be self-evident: that all men are created equal."* ... I have a dream that my four little children will one day live in a nation where they will not be judged by the color of their skin, but by the content of their character. I have a dream today." In his speech, Martin Luther King Jr. said his dream is to make a world where everyone is treated equally. And it is not only his dream but also some 26th wavers of KMLA's. Seven 26th wavers–Chae-won Kang, Yun-je Sung, Minhyeok Lee, Sanghyo Lee, Jungyoon Lim, Seoyoung Jeon, and Eungyeol Hwang– put their effort into making an equal world for blind people through the Integrated Project.

Eungyeol Hwang said that he decided to make the Integrated Project Team 'Now You See Me!' after suddenly noticing people couldn't touch the braille of the elevator buttons because of the antimicrobial film. (Because of COVID-19, a lot of people attached antimicrobial film to the elevator buttons to prevent infection.) It was evident that it would make blinds unable to use the elevator. It made him think that there must be a lot of other unknown cases where blinds are marginalized. Eungyeol Hwang stated he wanted to research those cases and solve those problems.

The first thing they did was to improve their knowledge about blind people. To deepen their understanding of the blinds, they visited the Myungjin School of Gangwon, a private special-education school that provides customized education services for blind people. The team visited the school and had a conversation with the vice-principal, an English teacher, and students.
Meeting the vice-principal and students, they talked about their daily lives. The integrated project team found out the students were separated from the public welfare services such as public transportation or public libraries. For blind

people, it was hard to use public transportation such as the bus or subway since there were unexpected stairs or rising spots that might threaten them. They also had hardships in using a public library since there rarely are braille books in a normal library. (On the other hand, the library of Myungjin School has a lot of braille books.)
However, the team also found the students were the same individuals, whether or not they had a disability. The integrated project team members and students of the Myungjin School both loved band activities. They both loved music and animation. They both loved school lunch and had a hard time studying. They shared their social media accounts and became friends with each other.

They started the integrated project because of the antimicrobial film of the elevator. So the team also made an antimicrobial film that can reflect the braille number of elevator buttons. The film was made of sodium alginate and distilled water by mixing it with a magnetic stirrer. By exposing it to a calcium chloride solution, they conducted a gel to print braille letters.

In addition, they pointed out the terrible environment of KMLA for blind people. They argued that there were too many slopes and no braille blocks on the campus. In the dormitory, two elevators don't have braille buttons, and there is no information for the blinds about the location of the office of each teacher. There is no actual support for the blinds in KMLA.

Langston Hughes, a great artistic contributor to the Harlem Renaissance wrote that America had never shown him the ideal aspect. (Just like what the American constitution says, its idealistic aspect is a world where everyone is treated freely and equally.) For him, America was always the land of discrimination and suppression. And the blind people in Korea also might think that way. The Constitution of the Republic of Korea states that all human beings must be treated equally. But the real society isn't treating them equally, isn't showing consideration for them. KMLA's campus is one example. Public transportation and libraries are the other examples. However, Myungjin School tried to solve the problem. The integrated project team, "Now you see me!" tried to solve the problem. So still, I have a dream, we have a dream, that my fellow blind citizens will one day live in a nation where they will not be judged by the disability of their body but by the content of their character.



"You are not disabled by the disabilities you have, you are able by the abilities you have."

- *Oscar Pistorius*

"Our greatest weakness lies in giving up. The surest way to succeed is always to try just one more time."

- Thomas Edison





Their Dream: KMLA Alumni

Seohyeon Choi

"Let us not study for the sake of personal gain but for the sake of learning itself."

The history of KMLA started in 1996. Time has passed, and the 28th wave is now attending and seeking their dreams; but like every wave that has come before it, students struggle in this somewhat cliche endeavor. To find out how students before us have handled this quest, Minjok Herald interviewed five different alumni; 6th waver Han Tae-Hwan, 10th waver Lee Hye-Bin, 13th waver Oh Jae-Hyeon, 14th waver Ha Su-Min, 17th waver Lee So-Yoon. They are now all out in society dreaming the same or different dreams that they had during high school.

6th waver Taehwan Han



MH: What was your dream when you were attending KMLA?

Han: It was a doctor. If life was guaranteed to some extent as an individual, I wanted to do something that would help others. Although I didn't have a strong desire for academic success, other than a specific occupation, a doctor, I also had a vague idea that it would be nice to be able to share the knowledge and experience I had acquired.

MH: What is your current occupation?

Han: I am currently working as a clinical professor in the Department of Pediatrics and Adolescents at a university hospital. I treat sick children, conduct research, and lecture to medical school students in the pediatric and neurology departments of universities. You can think that I am close to the dream I had when I was young.

MH: What is your current dream?

Han: It takes a certain amount of time to achieve personal achievement in any field. I don't think that time has come yet, so I'm going to focus on the present for now. I believe that choosing a career that you can find rewarding, rather than choosing a career that others think is good, is the driving force that will allow you to spend a long time without wavering. I'm not shaken right now, but another crisis will come and I think it would be good if I could prepare well and overcome it.

10th waver Hyebin Lee

MH: What is your current occupation?

Lee: I am currently working in strategy consulting. I went from being an architecture student to a construction company, and then a MBA consultant. I feel like all the dots are connected to make me who I am today. My dream of becoming an architect still remains in my heart, but my current focus is on energy-related work.

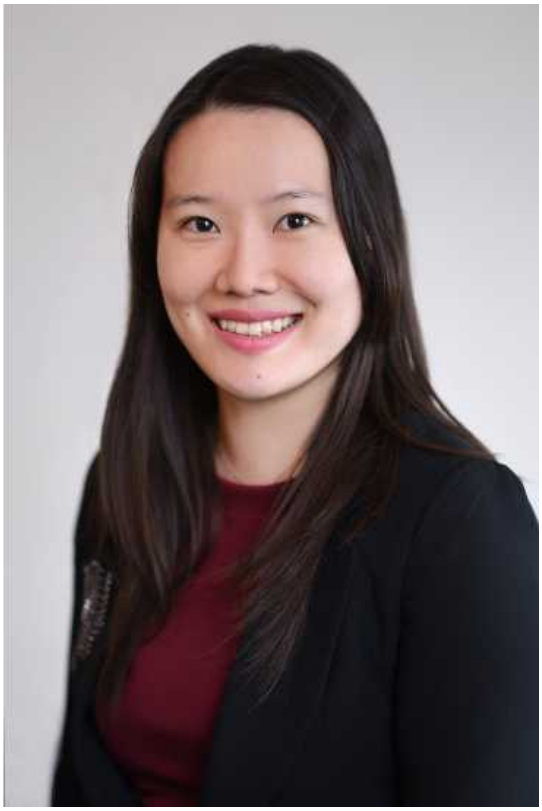
MH: How is it different from your dream in high school?

Lee: I wanted to be an architect. There is a gap between my high school dreams and what I am now, but I don't have big regrets. I realized later that the image of my dream that I was looking at was actually like seeing only one side of the moon. What I liked was analyzing and appreciating buildings, but architects design and build buildings differently. I think I've made choices in life by considering other aspects, financial issues, work-life balance, and the environment I want to work in, from the values of life I previously thought, only dreams! But it's

hard to say that I don't have any regrets about the road not taken!

MH: What is your current dream?
Lee: In fact, plans for the future are not as clear as before. Rather, as I settled down and had children, I really wanted to focus on my family and spend quality time with them rather than my career for a while. However, I always worry about my career, and since I am still very interested in design-related work, I live with the thought that I want to do a more design-related job someday.

13th waver Jaehyeon Oh



MH: What was your dream when you were attending KMLA?
Oh: I wanted to do something I was passionate about and good at, and I wanted to help people. Originally, I planned to become a doctor because I was interested in science, especially biology.

MH: What is your current occupation?
Oh: When I decided to go to a university in the United States, I realized that it was almost impossible to go to medical school as a foreign student in the United States. While thinking about what I could do by returning to my original values, I decided to pursue other strengths such as writing and debating. So I decided to become a lawyer. After graduating from Swarthmore, I went on to Harvard Law School and am currently a partner, leading the Civil Rights Department at a small litigation law firm in Manhattan, New York.

MH: You seem like doing a different job from your first dream.
Oh: Although my exact work and occupation are different, I am satisfied because my fundamental desire to help people and my desire to live well while doing what I love has been kept intact.

MH: What is your current dream?
Oh: Although I am a 7th-year lawyer and have not yet had a long career, I have been given the important title of a partner in a respected law firm. As I adapt to this role, I will do my best to ensure that the Civil Rights Department operates well in a long-term and stable manner, and I will do my best to help clients in the most difficult situations. My goal is to continue to do the work I love doing, for as long as possible.

14th waver Sumin Ha



MH: What was your dream when you were attending KMLA?

Ha: I just thought being a McKinsey/BCG consultant was so prestigious and cool, that was my dream! So basically my dream was limited to my career and professional "success" only.

MH: What is your current occupation?

Ha: After joining BCG for 5 years and then Amazon for a year, I'm now working on global expansion strategy & partnerships at an insurtech based in London. BCG was my dream come true and it helped me get to where I am now, but I'm also happy I left. My dream is now less confined to a specific brand (eg: Mck, BCG) and my career, rather it's a balance of professional challenges and personal life goals.

MH: How is it different from your dream in high school?

Ha: Tying my dream to a certain company meant that after I achieved it, I wasn't sure where I should go next. It's not a bad thing to have a very specific goal as it can be a strong motivation, but if I could go back in time, I'd give more thought to what I'd actually like to do professionally & personally. For example, do I want to develop high-level strategic thinking at a C-suite level; be able to project manage, execute complex operations, and deliver targets; be able to strike multi-million/billion dollar deals with global partners, etc? Outside of work, what kind of a person do I want to be and what kind of a life do I want to lead?

In high school, I was too attached to the idea of "success" which simply meant making a lot of money in a big position at a respectable organization. I'm still struggling with this but starting to learn that there is so much more to life (at the risk of sounding cliche!).

MH: What is your current dream?

Ha: My dream is now more focused on the kind of life I want to live and the type of person I want to be. Career is an important part but still just one part of the wider dream. For example:

1) I'm based in London, but I want to be able to spend 1-2 months in Korea every year. This means I need some financial stability to afford this and have flexible working location/hours (eg: does my job allow me to work from Korea for a few weeks in a year?)

2) I want to keep growing professionally, rather than stay somewhere comfortable where I know I'm good at my job. Does my current work position offer this challenge/opportunity?

3) I want to have a growth mindset vs a fixed mindset: ie, I want to feel smart & content when I've cracked a difficult challenge I've been struggling with for a while, versus feeling smart when I'm better than someone next to me / when I'm good at something at a first try.

4) I want to keep learning new skills - this can be work-related (eg: sales), artistic skills like the piano, or learning a new language.

5) I want to stay healthy mentally and physically - this means having the time to workout frequently, cook balanced meals, manage my stress, and stay happy.

17th waver Lee So-Yoon



MH: What was your dream when you were attending KMLA?

Lee: Even when I was a student at KMLA, my dream was to become a professor, and my desired majors were Political Science or East Asian Studies. Actually, at that time, I think I had a stronger desire to become a professor rather than a person in other occupations. When I think about it now, I had just vaguely imagined myself running around the campuses of foreign universities and graduate

schools. Still, one thing I was certain of was my determination to write something as an author for the rest of my life.

MH: What is your current occupation?

Lee: Currently, I am in the Ph.D. course in the Department of Sociology at the University of Chicago and researching the K-pop industry. To put it briefly, the goal is to look at the work experiences of people working in the K-pop industry through in-depth interviews and ethnography and to analyze sociologically how K-pop is produced. In this process, the past of me stanning a few idols is paying off. In some ways, I think I have achieved a 'virtue-to-work coincidence'. I have been interested in pop culture, especially pop music since I was young, so I think it was natural that these personal passions and interests eventually led to academic research.

MH: How is it different from your dream in high school?

Lee: What I look like now is something I couldn't have imagined when I was 18, but I think if you were to tell my 18-year-old self what I'm doing now, she would understand. It took me almost 10 years to find what I really wanted to do, and I am very satisfied with the feeling that I am getting closer to who I want to be through the process. Sometimes I wonder what it would have been like if I had majored in sociology, linguistics, or cultural anthropology since undergrad, but I think I can be confident in the path I am taking now that I have taken a long way round.

MH: What is your current dream?

Lee: Now my dream is to become a sociology professor teaching K-pop in the United States. In the American sociological community, there is still a tendency to view popular culture/music research as the responsibility/area of humanities scholars, but I would like to change the existing trends in academia through in-depth sociological research on Korean popular music. I sometimes envision myself launching an academic journal or establishing a research center that focuses on Korean popular culture in the future. Now that so-called "K-content" is receiving worldwide attention, it may not be such a distant dream.









The Role of Students and Student Council



School is where students come and learn about studies and the world. There are a lot of ways to nurture students, and one of the factors that must be included is the regulation of the students. Since all students know about it well, almost every student follows the regulations of the teachers and school.

On the other hand, the school belongs to the students. Although students in the school may, in some cases, receive instruction under control, nevertheless, the school belongs to the students. The school exists to provide the ultimate learning space for the students, and teachers exist to teach students. Therefore, the reason for the existence of the school is the student, hence the school belongs to the students.

Conversely, these two truths appear to be in opposition. The school belongs to the students, but the fact remains that they are regulated by the school. However, this is based on the basic principles of democracy. Democracy, in essence, is the people, who are the owners of the country, being controlled by the country. This is why we can easily agree with the idea that democracy should be realized within the school.

Recently, many events have occurred in KMLA. There was a controversy about whether to convert KMLA into an alternative school. The process in which the principal and the chairman of the school foundation avoided discussions with teachers and students to avoid this conversation, has been ongoing for several months. Initially, the teachers attempted to engage in dialogue. (At this time, the students remained silent.) When these attempts at communication were rejected by the principal and the chairman, the teachers began to demand the resignation of the principal and started more active protests. The resignation of the head of the academic affairs department and the senior social studies teacher are of this. At this point, the students also thought that they had to do something and began to take action.

After the situation escalated, the students and the student council began to move. As the resignations and protests of the teachers took place, the students held a special committee to listen to the opinions of all students. They also submitted a written request to the school leadership for an explanation of the situation.

Before a response was received, rumors spread that the headmaster had resigned, and with no reappearance at the school, the incident was temporarily resolved.

The students and the student council were not able to play a leading role in this incident. In reality, they were unable to participate in resolving any issues. However, the bigger problem lies in the fact that this issue has been forgotten by almost every student.

All of these problems and controversies such as the teachers' protest at morning assembly, the demand for the resignation of the headmaster by teachers, the resignation of the director of the division of Academic Affairs and the head teacher of the Department of Social Science, and the special committee of the student council are originated from the one topic: the conversion to an alternative school. Though the headmaster, in a post on the website, stated that there will be no conversion to an alternative school next year, the possibility of conversion to an alternative school remains since he also stated that school leadership will consider all possibilities.

However, as controversy grew over, the teachers submitting a resignation demand to the headmaster became

students' main issue, the original issue of the alternative school problem disappeared from our view. With the disappearance of the headmaster from the school, it seems that our students don't consider the alternative school problem anymore.

After this issue, through final exams, the Christmas party, the winter vacation, and the resumption of classes, the alternative school issue at KMLA will likely be forgotten completely among students. Since students had not thought about this issue before the conflict and resignation of the headmaster, when the conflict between the headmaster and teachers intensified, students could only say, "Please provide us with information so that we can now participate in the discussion."

Perhaps this demand should have been made much earlier. Our students should now realize that even if significant problems do not arise, they need to proactively discuss school issues among themselves in advance so that when real problems arise, students can do something. It is also pretty obvious that the student council should play a significant role during this process.

Is our student council really doing enough?

Student Council Statement

On the morning of July 18th, through a news article, we became aware of the fact that our school is considering a transition to an alternative school. Given that none of the students were aware of such a significant discussion taking place, the news came as a surprising revelation.

While we acknowledge that various options for the future of the school may be under consideration, and transitioning to an alternative school may be a viable solution, we express regret on behalf of the students for not being informed about the initiation of this transition. Students, as integral members of the school community, have the right to be respected and to actively engage with the school. We are not passive recipients of information but active participants in seeking knowledge, fostering continuous communication, and growing together with the school.

The guiding principle of our school is the promotion of national autonomy, emphasizing the core educational philosophy of determining our destiny directly with our own hands. In this regard, the student body, as a vital component of the school, wishes to present two demands to ensure effective representation and adherence to the ideology of national autonomy education.

- *35th Student Council & 101 Students*

Uniting Through Sports: The Shared Spirit of KMLA's Clubs

Inyoung Yi, Minseo Kang, Jeonggyeom Kuk

In the vibrant tapestry of KMLA's extracurricular scene, sports clubs serve as vibrant hubs where students unite under a common passion, forging bonds and pursuing excellence beyond the confines of academics. From basketball to volleyball, these clubs offer a sanctuary for individuals seeking camaraderie, personal growth, and the thrill of competition.

Behind every successful team lies a dedicated coach or captain, guiding members towards victory while fostering a sense of belonging. Whether it's Mr. Yang infusing physics knowledge into basketball coaching, Junyoung leading MVP with passion, or the inspirational journey of KBO, each club embodies a unique spirit while sharing common threads of purpose and camaraderie.

Gameover, KMLA's exclusive girls' basketball team, stands as a testament to the transformative power of sports in fostering community and personal growth. Led by Mr. Yang, the team combines professional knowledge with inspiring passion, dominating the court while emphasizing teamwork and unity. Mr. Yang reflects on his dual role as a physics teacher and basketball coach: "My professional knowledge of physics and inspiring passion create the perfect formula for coaching Gameover, dominating the court one by one."

Mr. Yang's journey with Gameover began unexpectedly, as he recalls: "Initially, I didn't start as the club supervisor from the beginning. When I first became a teacher, I wanted to try running a sports club. Then, the teacher who was in charge of the club decided to step down, and coincidentally, he remembered a personal conversation we had where I mentioned my interest in basketball. So, he asked me if I would like to take on the responsibility, and I agreed to give it a try."

In contrast, Hyungjun Park's experience as a catcher for the KBO underscores the transformative impact of sports clubs on personal development. Hyungjun reflects on his time in the league: "As a catcher for the KBO, I found solace and recognition within the team, forming lifelong friendships and cherished memories." His journey highlights the dedication and perseverance required to excel in professional sports.







Hyungjun's journey with baseball was marked by both triumphs and challenges. He recalls the thrill of competition and the camaraderie of the team: "One of the most memorable moments was winning the Gangwon State School Championship. At that time, I was a junior, and seniors took the lead in participating in the competition, so I didn't play a lot in the game. However, all the members had a strong desire for winning, putting in a tremendous amount of time and effort not only in regular practices but also in self-study time and weekend practices."



Meanwhile, Junyoung's leadership of MVP, the Minjok Volleyball Player, exemplifies the camaraderie and passion found within KMLA's sports clubs. Junyoung shares his insights into MVP's ethos: "MVP provided me with a sense of belonging and camaraderie, filling a void in my high school experience." His reflections on triumphs and regrets underscore the emotional journey of leadership and teamwork. He still keeps the graduation present (mechanical pencil with his name written) his team members gave him in his pencil case.



Junyoung recalls his favorite and least favorite memories with MVP: "The most memorable moment that comes to my mind right now is probably winning the Gangwon State School Championship. If I were to mention a regrettable moment, it would be during the same championship where I served as the captain, but we didn't win. Thinking back, not winning is the most regrettable part because I feel I didn't put in all the effort I could as the captain."

Across different sports and backgrounds, the stories of Gameover, MVP, the KBO, and other clubs resonate with themes of dedication, camaraderie, and personal growth. Whether it's winning championships or overcoming setbacks, these clubs serve as crucibles where students forge lifelong friendships and learn invaluable life lessons.

Moreover, the challenges faced by club leaders—be it scheduling conflicts or motivating team members—underscore the importance of communication, empathy, and resilience in fostering a thriving club culture. Despite the pressures of leadership, these individuals remain steadfast in their commitment to creating inclusive and supportive environments where every member can thrive.

Ultimately, sports clubs at KMLA represent more than just avenues for athletic prowess—they are microcosms of the school's ethos of excellence, camaraderie, and personal growth. Through shared experiences, challenges, and triumphs, these clubs unite students from diverse backgrounds, fostering lifelong friendships and shaping the next generation of leaders both on and off the field.

In KMLA's halls where knowledge gleams,

Sports clubs thrive, fulfilling dreams.

Unity and spirit, in each club we find,

A tapestry of strength, to excellence bind.



Inside Dreams Lies Creativity

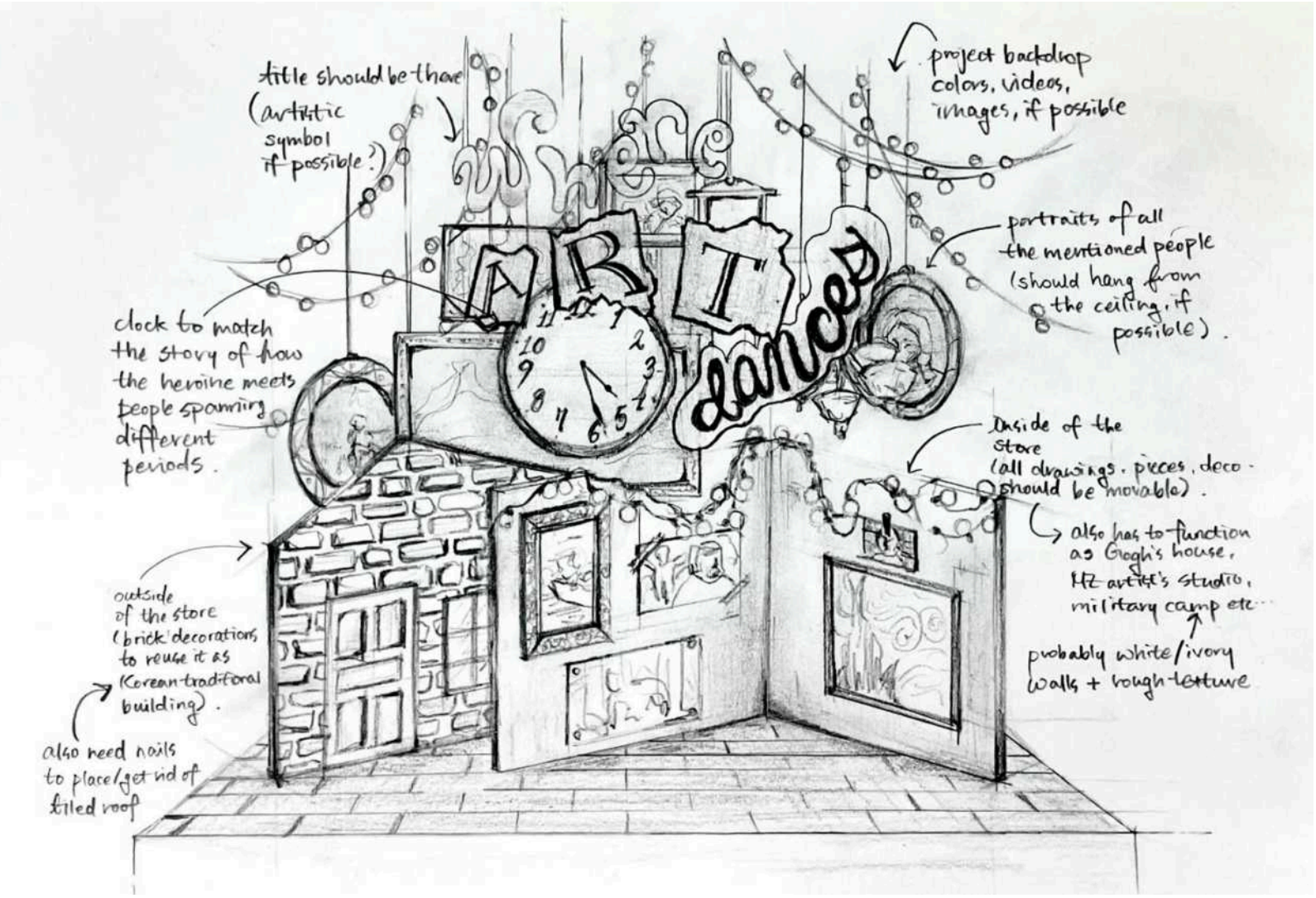
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"To create a work of art is to create the world."

-Kandinsky

Art Facilities in KMLA: A Deeper View

Seyoung Lim



-Art contributed by 26th Waver, Seoin Kim

While not every student in KMLA is a budding Picaso, many take art classes to release stress and nurture their artistic talents suppressed by competitive studying. KMLA offers a variety of art subjects, such as Fine Arts, Korean Calligraphy, and AP Studio Art: Drawing.

In Fine Arts, students can try diverse art styles they wish, as long as it satisfies the given theme. AP Studio Arts is similar, with portfolios to finish at the end of the term. For Korean Calligraphy, students can write what they want from English to Korean to Chinese characters. They often present their writings to the teachers they like, and you can see calligraphies on the walls of teachers' offices. Some Convergence and Imagination courses even include art projects–expressing literature works in art forms. As we can see, KMLA provides students with chances for different types of art.

However, places to enjoy these art classes are, sadly, limited. All of the Western Art classes are held in a single office. This is because only a single teacher can teach art to students professionally. Calligraphy is no different. A

single teacher in a single office takes care of dozens of students. It is not only troublesome for teachers to handle all the students taking the class, but it's also difficult for students to finish their artwork in a small space with other people close to them.
Below is a short interview with Ms. Da-hyi Kim, in charge of Fine Arts and AP Studio Art: Drawing.

MH: Do you think the school's environment is sufficient for the students to learn arts?
Kim: For Fine Arts, I would say I'm 80% satisfied with it. And I also think the class level is higher than most ordinary high schools. The school also tries to provide most of the materials unless they're too expensive, so that's a plus point. But for the other 20%, I wish I could secure more facilities and places. Since I graduated from an Arts middle and high school, I had plenty of space to work on my pieces. It would be nice if there were separate places for different types of artwork, but it would be tough regarding the current school situation.

MH: In that case, if you could make changes to the school to improve the art curriculum, would you enlarge the area?
Kim: Sure, I would. There is a Chemistry lab and Physics lab here, so why not Arts? I once informed the school because I thought the space was too limited, but it looked hard to fix.

MH: Then are there any measures you're taking to overcome the physical problems?
Kim: Students draw things and often do crafting as well. But sometimes, when they say they want to film a video or take a photo, I allow that also. And since our school has large spaces, I encourage them to set up their artwork inside the school. Or make a performance and record it for submission. I try to make it as diverse as possible.

MH: There is a recently installed workspace now. Won't it be possible to do some form of art there?
Kim: About that, two students already created their work with 3D printers there. It looks like kids will use it versatilely, and I also hope to share the place in the coming years.

As we can see, though the physical restrictions make it hard for students to create big-scale artwork, it is possible to pursue creativity and originality through diverse portfolio formats and newly established facilities. The new workspace will resolve some of the limitations students have felt until now since the place is suitable for producing art pieces with 3D printers and carpentry. Because of these reasons, many students manage to find ways to express their thoughts.

However, the problem still exists with artistic clubs in KMLA. Theater clubs, for example, face difficulties when they stage a play. Most of their plays take place in the auditorium, where the set is too small to perform particular scenes. 27th waver Dahyun Song, the head of the musical club *The Scene*, commented, "There are no passageways behind the stage for the actors to move around, so we have to make stage curtains ourselves. We have only one color for the lights, and it's hard to give spotlights because they go on and off simultaneously. Since the stage is small, structuring a group scene is difficult."

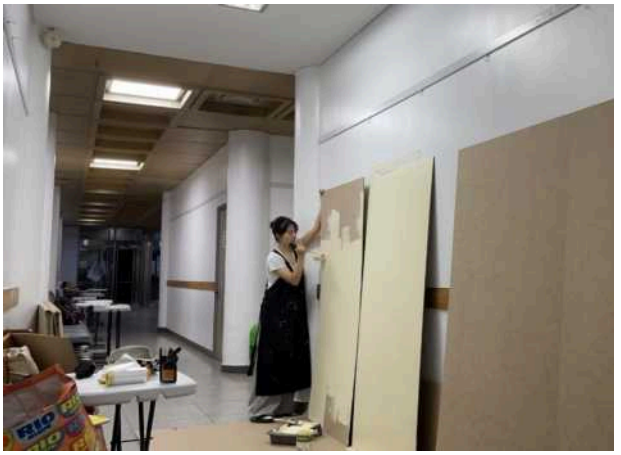
She also added, "We make backgrounds used in plays on our own, too, and since the size is big, it's tiring to carry them around whenever we're practicing. The club has to purchase pin marks for the play at private expense, which is quite a fortune."

Though a musical is an activity that needs dedication and a lot of effort, *The Scene* was established seven years ago. Though many facilities have been upgraded until now, there are many improvement points, as viewed in the interview above. The fact that the auditorium is the only place for them to stage their play is another problem. Performing a musical there is similar to setting up an annual makeshift stage. Considering it will resume its play in the following years, some development in KMLA seems necessary to improve artistic activities.

The best solution to this problem would be increasing the space for art activities. However, since such a way has many down-to-earth limitations, we could take different approaches. For one, using online tools could be a suggestion. Art programs such as Adobe Photoshop offer

users almost limitless access to any type of artwork. Students can use the functions within the program to create works from simple doodling to imaginative projects. Though not as professional as Photoshop, there are various high-quality free applications to download. If space restrictions create constraints in the art forms, we might as well try to develop a new one.

Compared to other schools, art facilities in KMLA generally have high standards. Not many schools can afford canvases and acrylic paints for a single student's artwork. However, enclosed offices packed with dozens of students, physical limitations for artistic club performances, and private expense is a problem that needs to be improved. With more interest and support, art activities in KMLA will also flourish, showing the uniqueness of KMLA once more.





Lights, Camera, Acceptance: Unveiling the Secrets Behind the Legendary 'Bryson and Apollo Records'

Inyoung Yi

"Our dreams are the canvas, and our creativity is the paint that brings them to life." Entwined within the corridors of a high school for three impactful years, students unleash the wild spirit of their vibrant youth. Occasionally, this untamed creativity crystallizes into a masterpiece, a fleeting moment captured on the canvas of time. With strokes of imagination on the canvas of our dreams, a unique tapestry of experiences comes to life. Over the 28-year history of KMLA, numerous individuals have left an indelible mark by painting their canvas in ways unimaginable. This interview, conducted on November 15th via Zoom, delves into the insights of our esteemed alumni, Wonjae Lee and Jaeho Kim, the creative minds behind Bryson and Apollo Records, renowned for their masterpiece, ED Jump.



MH: Hello, it's a great honor to meet you today. Please briefly introduce yourself.

Lee: Hello, I'm Wonjae Lee, an Architecture major at Cornell. My life currently involves a lot of coursework, but I'm doing fine and enjoying it.

Kim: Hi, I'm Jaeho Kim, and I'm currently studying in Columbia. It's been a while since I sat on the KMLA campus, and it feels great to see it again!

MH: Does the KMLA family still exist at Cornell/Columbia? How often do you think of KMLA?

Lee: When I first came to Cornell, it was in a very rural town. I immediately noticed its similarities to KMLA life. The environment, the surroundings – everything felt familiar. While there are KMLA people here, we don't interact frequently. I don't think about it often, but if I have the chance to go back to Korea, I always try to visit KMLA.

Kim: I go to Columbia, which is more urban and densely populated. While there haven't been many graduates within Columbia recently, there are a lot of KMLA alumni building careers in New York, making the community active. We often discuss KMLA experiences, when we are talking to each other. We all have different experiences, but there is a lot of relevance.

MH: How did the Bryson and Apollo records start? Were you both part of it?

Lee: The framework was created by Jaeho Kim. Apollo was named after Jaeho, and Bryson was named after my senior-year roommate. Bryson was good at rapping, and the idea of producing for him emerged. BAR was initially not a club, it evolved into one. ED Jump was a project within the BAR, planned by Jinwoo Nam and me. It involved a lot of sound mixing, recording, and editing, with visuals mostly created by Wonjae and Jinwoo. We were all really tired during early college application and we decided to have some fun.

MH: What was your initial goal when establishing Bryson & Apollo Records?

Kim: Initially, it was a hobby, starting with the idea of making music with a talented friend. Over time, the scale grew, and the satisfaction derived from hands-on work led to more significant media projects even in college. A

hobby eventually led to finding the basis for academic interest in college.



MH: You hinted at this earlier; what inspired you to create ED Jump?
Lee: 'Boy Jump' was trending during that time. Talking with Jinwoo about essays led to the idea of adapting that to our situation, creating a fun reflection on activities, honors, and high school life.

MH: What's your favorite lyric in Ed Jump?
Kim: *"International class my EC f**king lie. Yay~"*. If you actually spend an entire year thinking about your common app which will be you soon, you will be able to feel what we mean by this.
*"So many freaking applicants and I'm the b****h among them"* I still think this lyric is such a vibe. After coming to college myself, I learned that the standard that we set in high school is not really the reality. There are so many people who don't meet the expectations that we had back in high school with all those grades and other standards we've set. Some students have very low AP scores and standardized testing and it made me wonder how that person got in. So what I learned is that the standard that we once believed is true and that we've set for ourselves is very far from what the answer is.

There were a lot of curse words back then now looking at it, but censoring was not that strict when we were making this video. This wasn't a club activity and we didn't have anyone censoring these things. For me specifically, now as a junior year in university looking for interns and thinking about getting a job, there's a lot of similarity between preparing for university and a job. It wasn't a complete lie of course when I was applying to college, just trying to appeal to those universities I'm applying to. Even after high school, I repeated these processes over and over again in my professional life and career. That's what I recently felt.

MH: In the video, you specifically mentioned Mr. Yoon and Mr. Garrioch. Why these teachers and not others?
Lee: Mr. Yoon, responsible for college counseling, offered practical advice to us. He did college counseling for quite a long time. So students and Mr. Yoon had love and hate relations with one another. He always told us to do this and that but we never really listened to him. Mr. Garrioch was always chill taking care of our essays. He never said any bad stuff to us. And he encouraged us to do fun activities. He was really a big figure to us in that sense.



MH: The emotions in your high school lyrics resonate with KMLA students. Was KMLA a significant inspiration for your passion projects?
Lee: As students who attended KMLA myself, we get used to the unique culture and practices that our own school has. However, from the perspective of people outside of our school, it's really a weird school. The

environment itself is so weird and there are so many systems that make me wonder why they ask us to do all this. So, when I was in high school I think I can say that no one didn't have any complaints about the school. Thinking back as a graduate, living together in an extraordinary environment is really special. Also since we bond really strongly, even after you graduate there are a lot of situations where your relationships are limited to socializing with people from KMLA. We can't ever just get rid of the weird 3 years that we have spent. The norms and rules that we only know, and inside stories that we can talk freely to those kinds of friends don't exist outside of KMLA. Since our music and lyrics were talking about those kinds of inner boundaries that was a huge inspiration for us when we were working on those projects.



MH: Reflecting on your high school masterpiece, what are your thoughts on your work during that time?
Lee: Thinking back at my senior life, especially these activities, it was really fun. I thought senior year would be very stressful but it was actually not. It was the best moment of myKMLA life. I had a lot of fun times with my friends and that was great. Maybe that's why senior life is so memorable for me. After coming to Cornell , a student from HAFS (another high school in Korea) asked me if I knew about this video called 'ED Jump'. Of course, he didn't know that it was me who made that lol. I'm still in disbelief that this video is spreading across other schools as well.

MH: Among all the remarkable works of your records, do you have a favorite?
Lee: In most of the past works I did, I was in charge of editing videos. The only piece that I recorded myself was the ED jump and that's why I have a strong affection towards it. I spent the longest time working on this and it was the most fun project that made me start this and end it voluntarily. So, this is my favorite one so far and the one that we still talk about to one another.



MH: Do you still continue your passion for video making?
Lee: While not specifically videos, skills in graphic design and visual elements from that time are still applied, given the unrelated nature of architecture and media projects. It's not totally unrelatable to the graphic designing and log designs that I did back in high school.

MH: Were there any specific motivations that drove you to work on these projects?
Lee: I wasn't the one that rapped and I never did anything related to this. Jaeho and a different friend just made this to record some music and I was really close with Jaeho. It was a bestie group. In KMLA, there is a division of interests depending on which track you are in. So it was more tight bonding between international students with essays and other things we are going through. It was quite natural for me to join that in that essence. Furthermore, the only person who knew how to work on logs and graphics was me, so needs were fulfilled on both sides. This helped my individual development and even in the common app, I was able to put this in such as adding the



website of BAR in additional information and stuff. Also, it looked really fun so that's why I joined.

MH: Were there any hardships or challenges you faced during your work?

Lee: It was the first time for me to do actual recording and editing videos when I worked on ED jump. I knew theoretically how to do it but I couldn't make it come to life. To work on ED jump I had to learn video editing skills by myself, etc. Starting a whole new software system was a lot of pressure as a senior in high school but since I had thought I really wanted to do this I just made it happen. In order to edit videos you need a good laptop and my laptop wasn't even that good. There were some technical challenges. Still, due to the technical limits, there are some parts that I regret.

MH: How did you manage your hectic schedule and still find time for these fun projects?

Lee: Other than BAR, when I was attending high school I was the president of the executive council. It might be quite different from the current student government but back then there were so many things we were in charge of. Planning for events, getting called by teachers, etc. Our school has a huge focus on student autonomy so they tend to make students do everything. Ironically the term that I was the president was the term that I had the best grade. I think when people become busier, you then have these thoughts that if you don't do this now, you'll never be able to study or do the work you have to do. So, automatically my brain functioned in a way to use my time efficiently. Eat your meals and in the case of sleep deprivation after eating I came back to my dorm and slept for a few minutes and worked on little things I had to do. I tried to use those flowing times wisely. I'm actually a power J, as in MBTI J. I think because I lived that way I was able to do all the things I wanted to do.

MH: As someone who successfully navigated the college application process, do you have any advice for current KMLA students facing challenges in their applications?

Lee: For the Common App, first, when you set a specific image and you want to look that way doing some activities that align with that image, you are the one that's going to be stressed out the most. For example, I wanted to major in architecture but there's nothing that you can do as a high school student. To make this work I put in some subjects that align this image but it wasn't really fun for me. Whatever decision you make every moment of your life, in the bigger picture, you're gonna end up at a point you imagined anyway. Think about going in a straight line or some sort of line that detoured. A Common App is something that shows who you are really not what you want to be. If you try to pursue some fake or artificial version of yourself putting in ec and honors that align with it, it becomes imperfect at the end. Do whatever you want to do. Don't doubt your decision, trust yourself, and move on because that'll make you end up in a position where you want to be.



Follow the QR to watch ED Jump!

Hollywood in KMLA – Jaehyun Seo

Inyoung Yi

In the captivating realm of storytelling through visuals, filmmaking stands as a formidable force, weaving emotions, laughter, and tears into the fabric of our experiences. At KMLA, our community has been enriched by exceptional talents in this dynamic industry. Beyond the melodies of music, the cinematic artistry of our alumni has left an indelible mark on the hearts of audiences, both near and far. In this exclusive interview, conducted on November 24th, we journey into the creative landscape of one of our distinguished alumni, Jaehyeon Seo. As the visionary mind behind some of KMLA's most celebrated films, Jaehyeon shares insights into the craft, the inspiration behind the lens, and the impactful stories that have unfolded within the frames of his work.



MH: Please provide a brief self-introduction.
Seo: I'm 20th wave Jaehyun Seo, and I graduated from KMLA in 2018. I enrolled at Columbia University to study film. I've never had an interview with a school press back when I was a student, so thank you Minjok Herald for bringing me back to KMLA after all these years!

Follow this QR Code to watch UpHill!

MH: Is the KMLA family still active at Columbia? How often do you reminisce about your time at KMLA?
Seo: I actually left Columbia in my sophomore year and entered the Korea National University of Arts this year, still majoring in film. There are many reasons behind this decision, but mostly I wanted to have more hands-on filmmaking experience and work in the Korean film industry. But I can definitely say that you will be able to find a KMLA family anywhere you go. I was able to find one in Columbia, and also in K-Arts. I could always find a sense of solidarity and warmth shared among KMLA alumni. If you need help from a graduated alumni, never hesitate to reach out even if you've never seen them before. They'll be more than happy to talk with you.

MH: When did your interest in the film first emerge, and what drew you to it?
Seo: I guess I've always been drawn to moving images since I was a child, but what really ignited my passion to pursue this career was the reaction of the audience. I joined the Department of Broadcasting by chance when I was 10 and made a short stop motion animation using four slippers that race like cars in the hallway. My friends cheered and laughed so hard watching my movie. It was such an exciting experience as a kid that shaped the rest of my life. I truly love the sense of collective immersion when a lot of people are watching the same film, people breathing together with the film.

MH: Among the films you worked on at KMLA, do you have a favorite?
Seo: It's difficult to pick one. "Dry Monsoon" was definitely the largest and most ambitious production I had in KMLA, so naturally I have most memories around that film. I like "Uphill" because of its simplicity and reflection of reality. "Project Graduation" is a documentary film to celebrate the 20th wave's graduation, consisting of interviews on the feelings around finishing the teens and

proceeding to the twenties. It's like a time capsule. It is the film that I revisit most often.



MH: 'Uphill' was notably realistic and evocative for many KMLA students. How did your time at KMLA influence and inspire your work?

Seo: We were in 11th grade at that time, taking Mr. Tweedie's filmmaking class. I wanted to make a very short film with Jimin, my close friend and a talented writer. He had an idea to write a story that reflects the reality of KMLA students. It was a natural conclusion in a way - what a film set on KMLA, casting a KMLA student can do the best is to portray a slice of life in KMLA itself. I remember talking a lot with Jimin and deciding to capture a frustration that all students in KMLA go through at least once. We hoped to sympathize with our friends struggling in this extremely competitive environment. Not long after uploading the film on YouTube, a friend who had taken a gap year came to me, said he cried while watching it, and thanked me for making the film. That was one of the most special moments I had in KMLA.

MH: Your films exhibit a high level of professionalism. How did you hone your filmmaking skills?

Seo: Thank you for praising my work, but professionalism is an overstatement. I was just a high school student with some basic cinematography and editing skills, struggling to make a resemblance of a film with a cheap DSLR camera and a bunch of friends who had no filmmaking experience at all. It was a tedious process of failure, revision, and failure again. What I tried hard to do was to restrain myself from thinking that "it's good enough." There's always something to fix, a better decision to make if you look close enough.

MH: Reflecting on your high school film projects, what are your thoughts looking back?

Seo: Honestly, it is really hard to sit through a film I made in the past. The outright mistakes and shortages of the film stand out too obviously for me. It inevitably makes me think of all the wrong decisions I made when I was a younger director and that's pretty embarrassing sometimes. But all those imperfect pieces of work are evidence of my growth as well, so I try to embrace them and learn from them.

MH: Do you have a special memory from your time working on films at KMLA?

Seo: The production schedule of "Dry Monsoon" was very dependent upon the weather. To shoot the climactic ending scene, we could do nothing but wait for the rain to pour, but it seemed like the weather was against us. Then suddenly, with less than a week left until the end of the summer session, heavy rail fell. All the actors and crew rushed out of the dorm with the equipment for the shoot at once, and we finished 2 scenes within an hour. The rain stopped right after we got the final shot. We were all soaked in rain but couldn't be happier. When I think about the joy of filmmaking, this specific moment is still the first thing that comes to my mind.



Follow QR Code to watch Dry Monsoon !

MH: What were some challenges or limitations you faced while working on films at KMLA?

Seo: Every single moment was filled with challenges. We had very limited time to shoot, few choices of location, cast members, clothes, props, and everything. We couldn't even imagine a nice camera or lighting equipment. We didn't even have a proper clapper, so a leather belt was used to make that clapping sound. But in hindsight, I think such a limited setting also functioned as a catalyst for creativity for me and other crew members. We had to find a way to overcome those limitations using what we had in hand, and it often led to unique, unexpected results that added to the power of the story.



MH: Are you still pursuing your passion for filmmaking? What notable differences do you see in your current work compared to your time at KMLA?

Seo: Yes. I still love to watch and make movies. It never changed for the last decade, so I strongly believe that it will continue to be that way. The short films I'm directing now in college are, of course, shot with much better tools and environment, thus they are superior in objective quality. My work in KMLA, however, will always occupy a special place in my heart regardless of their technical imperfections. They cannot be made anywhere else or with anyone else. Those films are specific to that moment of my life. The good memories of making those films in KMLA will always be the cornerstone of my future pursuit of filmmaking.

MH: Having successfully navigated your time at KMLA, do you have any advice for current KMLA students?

Seo: The workload and life routine required to navigate through KMLA is, frankly, quite insane. Facing huge academic challenges daily while managing to actively participate in several clubs and prepare for an olympiad at the same time (which is what a lot of you might be doing now), will wear you out someday. It may sound cliche, but please treat yourself. Eat well and sleep well - yes, I know it's often impossible under the circumstances, but at least try to do one of them properly. Keep your friends close to you. My friends were the only reason why I could laugh off all the crazy stuff I had to deal with in school and endure. It's a long race uphill, so please do not run like a sprinter. I wish all of you reading this the best of luck.

The Minjok Herald

Dreams of KMLAians

All our dreams can come true, if we have the courage to pursue them.

\- *Walt Disney*

My dream is to be someone who can be proud of myself.

My dream is to know who I really am and fully cherish myself.

My dream is to live my life, freely and without restrictions.

My Dream is to change the world to a better place.

My Dream is to be the person I want to be.

Harmonies Unveiled: A Deep Dive into KMLA's Musical Tapestry

Inyoung Yi, Sangmin Lee

Nestled within the illustrious corridors of KMLA lies a rich tapestry of musical expression, where the echoes of dedication and passion reverberate through the hearts of performers and audiences alike. At the forefront of this melodic realm stand two distinguished ensembles: The Scene and KMLA Orchestra. While each carries its own unique flavor, they share a common thread of artistic fervor that binds them together in the pursuit of musical excellence.

The Scene, a beacon of theatrical prowess reminiscent of Broadway productions, emerged from the creative cauldron of KMLA's 22nd wave. Jiwon Kim, a luminary of The Scene's 23rd wave, reminisces about the club's meteoric rise, "I first saw them perform in a club exhibition... They were good at singing so I thought I'd be able to perform a quality show like them if I joined this club." With emotionally charged performances that breathe life into characters and narratives, The Scene has captivated audiences with its spellbinding storytelling through song.



Conversely, the genesis of KMLA Orchestra remains enshrouded in the annals of history, obscured by the passage of time and transitions between waves. Yet, its establishment speaks to a longstanding tradition of classical orchestral music at KMLA, where dedication to the craft echoes through the corridors of time. Ahn Dong Woo, a venerable member of KMLA Orchestra's 20th wave, fondly recounts the camaraderie and dedication shared among members, noting, "During my time, we practiced once a week in the first semester, and in the second semester, we met at least twice a week... Our practice sessions for Samicheum (annual concert) were known to be more intense."



Amidst the crescendo of dedication and passion, both ensembles have weathered their fair share of trials and tribulations. Kim reflects on The Scene's journey, recalling, "Right before the Musical performance, there was a time we practiced till midnight... After practicing so hard... talking things like 'We Can Kill the Show' would be my favorite." Similarly, KMLA Orchestra members recount arduous practice schedules and the pursuit of perfection for performances like Minsaeum, where the symphonic crescendo of dedication echoes through the hallowed halls of the institution.

Beyond the spotlight, both ensembles foster a sense of community that transcends mere musical collaboration. Kim muses on The Scene, saying, "Members were sort of

like family to me... it was really helpful for my self-esteem." Similarly, KMLA Orchestra members embrace a familial atmosphere, forging lasting bonds amidst shared musical experiences.

As alumni reflect on their time in these musical ensembles, they offer pearls of wisdom and encouragement to current and future members. Kim extends a heartfelt message, "We're always here for you... It's really important to make a culture that cares for each other." These sentiments encapsulate the essence of dedication and community that defines the enchanting world of KMLA's musical prowess.

The journey of musical exploration does not end on the stage but extends into the very fabric of life itself. Through the lens of The Scene and KMLA Orchestra, we glimpse the transformative power of music to shape identities, forge friendships, and imbue existence with meaning and purpose.



In the words of Kim, "We look at each other's faces 8 hours a day just for The Scene... It's really great to have a lot of people that share the same special memory." Indeed, it is these shared memories and experiences that bind together the members of these musical ensembles, creating a legacy that transcends time and space.

As we venture deeper into the harmonious realms of KMLA's musical tapestry, let us not only marvel at the artistry on display but also celebrate the spirit of dedication, passion, and camaraderie that pulsates at its core. For it is through the collective pursuit of musical excellence that we find solace, inspiration, and a deeper connection to the symphony of life itself.








Photo by 26th waver Hokwon Yoo

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While fast media like Instagram stories or shorts are prevalent today, traditional journalism remains significant due to its ability to capture events and immortalize the essence of writers and moments on paper. Through deep analysis and investigation spanning over months, journalists present new perspectives and unique voices to their readers. This year, in Features Minjok Herald, we went above and beyond by experimenting with this medium, not only presenting the facts but also incorporating our personal narratives into the story. From futuristic novels to in-depth analytic reports, to even person-to-person interviews, the crew of Feature uncovered diverse perspectives of the world around us. Even in seemingly ordinary events like club activities or school fairs, we discovered that everyone perceives them differently. So, we urge our readers to keep their eyes and ears open to the events around them, to listen and read, and to embrace the unique voices that make up the world into a more vibrant and colorful place.

Through the Charts: Students' Stance on Alternative School

Minseo Kang

"KMLA, Convert into Alternative School... Not to be swayed by the political regime."

On July 18th, bombshell news was dropped by The JoongAng Daily. The Korean Minjok Leadership Academy had decided to pursue a possible transition from an autonomous to an alternative high school to "ensure stable operations" outside the political powers. The talks and rumors of the school conversion had always existed; but what was significant about this article was that the news was directly from our headmaster, Mr. Han Manui. None of the teachers, students, or parents had any knowledge of the matter before it was publicized by outside news sources.

On that very evening of July 18th, the student council initiated a student petition voicing their complaint on the lack of communication with the headmaster's office on this matter. Even though the student council began this campaign right after the big Minjok Festival, the cafeteria was packed with students lining up to sign the petition.

In a nutshell, this alternative school controversy can be summarized as follows:

- January 17th: The current Department of Education passed a policy that will allow designated autonomous private high schools to continue, so long as each prestigious high school promises to accept 20% of regional students.
- This new policy has its roots in the recent attempts at the legislative amendment of the "Enforcement Decree of the Higher Education Act".

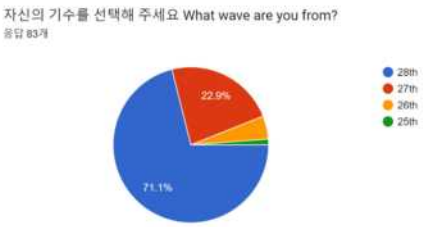
Mainly stating: 1) Selecting late-stage students and maintaining self-directed learning modalities 2) 50% of the students by most can be accepted through the regular administration process 3) at least 20% of the students need to be from the local state or province.

Recent polls show that 73.6% of students in national-level autonomous private high schools come from Seoul, leaving less than ⅓ for students from other regions. In the 28th wave of KMLA, only 7 out of 153 students were from Gangwon-do. Concerns about educational polarization and the perceived lack of contribution by autonomous private high schools to local education have been ongoing since the last government. Critics argue that these schools do little to improve the overall standard of local education, sparking debates about the fairness and purpose of their existence (The Hankyoreh, 1.18.2023).

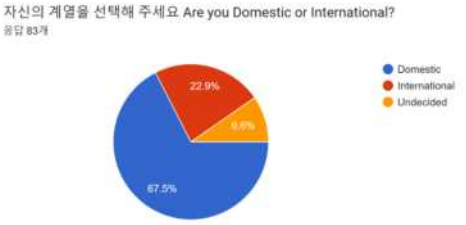
While this dilemma has been going on for years, there has yet to be any formal survey to statistically organize the views of students, or parents. Hence, on September 26th, the Minjok Herald conducted a student body survey for two weeks.

The survey's main question was: What are the students' views on the potential transition to an alternative school, as well as the mandatory policy of accepting 20% of students from Gangwondo if we continue as autonomous?

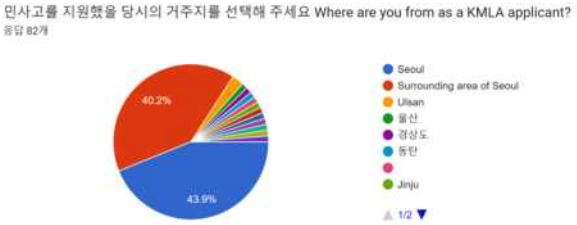
In the span of two weeks, 83 students, just over a fifth of all students, participated in the survey anonymously. The majority of them being the 28th wavers and domestic students <figure 1, 2>. Furthermore, the majority of the students were from Seoul or provinces near the capital during that time. Only 20% were from outskirt provinces like Ulsan and Jejudo.



<figure 1>

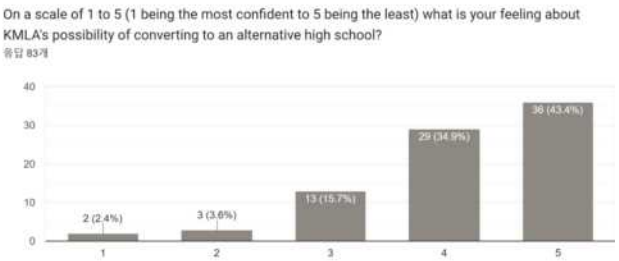


<figure 2>



<figure 3>

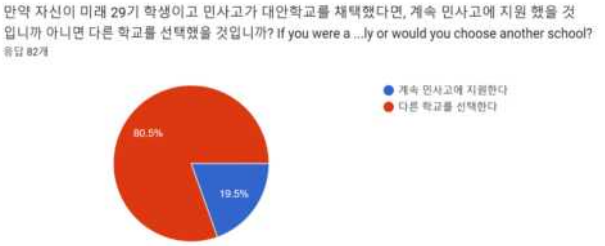
For the first part of the questionnaire, students were asked out of 1 to 5 how likely is the school's transformation into an alternative school <figure 4>, which was later followed up by why the students think so.



<figure 4>

Many students were confident that the transition was closer to a fantasy than a reality. When the students were asked the reason for their response, the majority of them stated that the modification of the alternative school was a solo decision made by a few high-ranking faculty members without notifying any parents, students, and the rest of the faculty. As KMLA is a private school run by the student's tuition fees, many participants believe that if the school heads simply make their own decisions, they would not be able to avoid the great outrage of the students and their families.

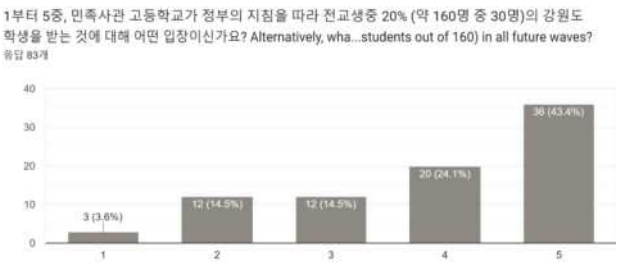
Later the students were asked if the school had transformed into an alternative school before applying, and if they would still apply to KMLA <figure 5>.



<figure 5>

As expected, except for 19.5%, students stated that they would have applied to a different school.

For the second part of the inquiry, students were asked their perspective on accepting 20% of students from Gangwondo into the school <figure 6>.



<figure 6>

Students' views were retrospectively negative on this as well. 67.5% of the students held strongly disapproving views on this demand placed on future student recruitment, with the following opinions as just a sample:

"KMLA's value is founded on accommodating gifted and passionate students of diverse fields. Allowing 30 people

to be accepted into this prestigious school just because they happen to be living in a specific region is a direct violation of KMLA values."

"In real life, there are very limited people who can afford to join this school. I doubt that there will be enough applicants for this school itself from Gangwon."

The general notion is this: accepting a large portion of students (20% fills up around 30 students for each year) is not fair or reasonable regardless of the policy's intentions.

To wrap up our investigation, students were asked their opinion of how KMLA would be affected by accepting 20% of students from Gangwon <figure 8>.



<figure 8>

68% of students are concerned about a potential negative impact on the school curriculum due to an influx of regional students, given Gangwon's rural reputation and the lack of access to elite academies like those in Gangnam. They worry about potential discrepancies affecting KMLA's competitive learning environment.

- In the "Enforcement Decree of the Higher Education Act," the Department of Education held the seventh meeting of the University Regulatory Reform Council to deliberate and confirm plans to amend the Enforcement Decree of the Higher Education Act.
- June 29th ~ August 8th: for 40 days, they review this amendment.

  Regardless of the public's voices against this legislative act, stating that the uniform egalitarian stance that the educational policy often takes is the real cause of such an issue, the current government's stance is that there is no place for compromise in passing this new law.

From this decision, as for the school:

- July 24th: according to the JoongAng Daily, the school stated that they are taking a backstep to review the transition.
- Yet, there is still no public statement from the Headmaster's Office clarifying their stance on alternative school transition (December 15th, 2024). Some argue they are unsatisfied with the statement, stating that the Headmaster is still giving off the subtle nuance of the possibility of the school continuing to pursue the transition in the future has not stopped yet.

As this issue is going on its 4th month, the anger of the school members has risen to the surface.

- November 17th: For the morning assembly, a group of teachers refused to join the headmaster at the podium and instead chose to stand in the back for the whole time.
- November 21st: The student body, on the other hand, held its student meeting on the eighth period of the following Tuesday, aiming to gather the students' opinions on this matter.

However, until that day, there had never been a serious student council meeting surrounding this issue before that day. Therefore, many students' opinions were often not collected ("We need to call the principal to step down", "I am against the transition of the alternative school"). They were not clear on what and why they were angry, whether the fact that the school board was refusing to communicate the current school situation or the fact that due to the government's policy, they needed to accept 10% of the Gangwon students. At this point, it is just a pure ball of chaos.

The results shown in the survey were neither surprising nor anything new. These views have been expressed for some time, which all concerned parties have been aware of. Although the altercation that this vague plan of conversion into an alternative school caused has seemingly

ended for now, we cannot forget about this student survey and what it represents – students want a transparent and clear school. Regarding the students' current polls, although in some perspectives students resisting both alternative schools and accepting local students could seem elitist or even selfish, as far as the value of the Minsa spirit goes, students want it to be preserved and cherished. Regardless of what future lies ahead, as a part of the "KMLA Family Members" we must not let our voice go silent. The only way to move forward is to take forward actions, we must not take the back seat but the driver's handle, continuously giving the school our opinion and stances, to make sure that we can keep the "Spirit of Minsa" alive.

The Minjok Herald

Dreams of KMLAians

My dream is to contribute to society through art that I can do.

My dream is to dance in toe shoes.

My dream is to defy our world's ephemeral nature.

My dream is to spread enlightenment to the world.

My dream is to live like a human being.

My dream is to be a person who can make warmth for others in the harsh winter.
My Dream is to build a rocket with everyone's aspirations.

My dream is to be proud of myself.

My Dream is to help the minority so that they can enjoy the same level of environment that the majority has already enjoyed.

My Dream is to add glimpses of love to this world.

My dream is to be a verb. Not to be categorized by mere nouns such as occupation, position, or a thing, but to be an evolutionary process, to be in the continuous movement, learning, and development. To be not limited by phrases but to be filled with possibilities.

My dream is to be happy with who I am, regardless of my location or eventual position. I want to avoid regrets about my choices and believe that embracing my true self is my best shot.

My dream is to live each day to the fullest, giving my best, so that I have no regrets before going to sleep.

Gat-Saeng 101: Living the Ideal Life of Minsa

Seoeun Yang, Minseo Kang

Time at KMLA passes differently. Our schedule spans self-study sessions from 7 p.m. to 6 a.m., transitioning to morning exercises. To navigate the stress of midterms and finals, energy drinks become essential. The student body often feels sleep-deprived and unprepared for tests, quizzes, or presentations.

We come into this great institution of Minsa, imagining ourselves living the Gat-seng, acing all the classes, holding great positions in clubs, and living out the best possible versions of ourselves. However, many of us end up doing the complete opposite, procrastinating on homework, being late for school, swimming in the pool of penalty points, and feeling as if we lost control over our lives.

In the freshman semester at KMLA, we discovered it's more than just clubs, stylish uniforms, and weekend rest stops. With honor and pride comes significant responsibility. While the school grants us autonomy in choosing classes, clubs, and allocating our 4 hours of self-study, we, as students, must bear the consequences. Ideally, this lesson would have been imparted before stepping on campus, but many of us learn it through trial and error, whether from first midterm report cards or sudden realizations.

However, lucky for the new incoming freshmen of KMLA, as professional Gat-sengers who are living the best possible version of our lives, we provide you with a step-by-step way of surviving in KMLA.

1. Learn to be Han Seok Bong

One factor that makes it difficult to pull all-nighters is that all the electricity and wifi are cut off as soon (or even before) the clock strikes 2:00. In that case, one can resort to studying in the dark. We can embody the soul of Han Seok Bong and practice reading and writing in the dark. Also, in the case of a Wi-Fi problem? Well, there are historical records that former alumni of KMLA have used the air-conditioning machine in the ceiling to have access to illegal Wi-Fi, so there is a way to get Wi-Fi even after the light-outs. But, this method has already been caught, therefore, for those who need it in the future, you need to think outside the box and figure out a new creative way.

2. Keep your notes close, but Monster closer

Yes, the notes you take during classes are crucial items to prepare for any quiz or exam, but if you are not in the clearest mind to read these materials, they are of no use. To have the right mindset and fully functioning brain, amateurs may decide to sleep early and rest. However, there is a better way: Monsters. An essential commodity in Minsa, these highly caffeinated drinks are always there for you in the most desperate times. Drinking a can of these can help you pull off all-nighters and still change and walk to your morning exercise! Those who have consumed this product state that: "I feel like my heart is beating 150 per second. I can't sleep even if I want to" The perfect partner for our desperate finals week, isn't it?

3. Learn to be the master of the Musical Chairs

Of course, even if you are in the right mindset, if the environment is not right, acing the vocabulary quiz you have in the first period is nearly impossible. Fortunately, the dormitory building provides the students with the perfect environment to focus on their material on the 11th floor. However, as it is indeed a limited space, it doesn't have enough chairs and tables to support more than 300 anxious students during the exam period. Hence, being nimble and quick is an essential characteristic to obtain the most favorable spot on the 11th floor. I suggest you practice your nimbleness with multiple rounds of musical chairs to tone your skill of stealing chairs from others. Practicing with heavy books and bags is highly recommended.

4. Clutch your bags and run for your lives

Being late for school isn't the best way to start the day. Two tardies a week equals penalty points. Penalty points lead to weekly court sessions. So it's probably best not to be late. This can all be solved by getting ready a bit quicker or waking up a couple of minutes early. But, for all my night owls, who just can't seem to wake up in time, here's what to do. Take the stairs. Maybe hop on the side elevators if you're feeling adventurous. But never the main elevators. You have to keep your ears open as well. The "10 seconds left!" bellowing down the stairs will help you never be late for school.

5. Get yourself a time-turner.

Even if you mastered all the above, time always seems to never be enough. You would always have to choose whether you would memorize the entire brain structure for AP Psychology, or study Mathematics for tomorrow's exam. Especially for an indecisive person like me, you may even spend your precious time pondering on what to do rather than doing anything. If that sounds like you, I highly recommend you follow the footsteps of Hermione Granger and get yourself a time-turner. Any machines are fine, like the Tardis, or the Time Stone from Dr. Strange. Yet, from my experience, time-turners are the most accessible, as one can easily get from Amazon at the price of $48.50. That way, you don't have to choose and do both! Isn't it convenient?

These are the pieces of advice we can give to the future Gat-seng wannabes. Reading again, "Gat-seng" for the KMLAians is highly restricted as "using your time efficiently and getting amazing grades". Hence, many of these tips are limited to studying and making the most of your time. However, to be completely honest, there is no true meaning of living "Gat-seng". It is all in the way you phrase the word. For some, having a periodic sleeping pattern may be the "gat-seng", for others, not being late for classes may be the idea of the "gat-seng". Ultimately, it is up to you how to live "Gat-seng". An imperfect reality for you can be a dream for another.

So I suppose the only advice for the newbies is just to "find your pattern" Just because these methods worked for me, or anyone, doesn't mean that it is for you. Trial and error is an essential material for finding your gat-seng. In the end, finding your footing, the perfect balance in the busy chaotic life in an isolated campus in Hoengseong, is up to you.

The Minjok Herald

Glimpse of KMLA Life







Nostalgia of the Past KMLA Family Members

Minseo Kang, Seoeun Yang, Inyoung Yi

The thing about memory is that it's phenomenally strong and easily triggered by even the smallest stimuli. A smell, a photo, or talking to an old friend can flood in the feeling of nostalgia. As KMLA goes into its 29th year standing, the Minjok Herald wanted to note this phenomenal year by bringing in some warm nostalgic feelings. We interviewed past KMLA family members ranging from students to parents to teachers to soak in the wonderful memories they shared with the school.



Mr. Neil Tweedie

MH: Hello! Thank you so much for participating in the interview! Before we begin, can you introduce yourself?
Mr.Tweedie: Hi! Good to see you! Well, My name is Neil Tweedie, I worked in KMLA from 2009 to 2019. I taught English Literature, Brit. Lit, World Lit, Writing, and Compositions, as well as a few AP classes. I also taught film studies when I was a member of KMLA.

MH: Film Studies? I don't think I've ever heard about that subject! Can you tell us more?
Mr. Tweedie: Oh, of course. This subject started as an IR (Individual Research) course, requested by the 13th wavers who were seniors then, since they knew that I loved movies. It wasn't structured or organized, but we gathered and watched movies and shared our thoughts about them. This continued to the 14th wavers as a film study course. One of the 14th wavers, Kim Min Ju - whom I still keep in contact with over the years - took this class and later got accepted to film school in Columbia.

Later on, Minju sent me the syllabus for the Introduction to Film Study course at Columbia, and using that we studied the history of films, watched different genres and styles, and critiques over the years. During the summers, we took a deep focus on a filmmaker or a genre and watched a bunch of them. For the 19th and 20th wavers, they especially wanted to do production, but that wasn't my field. Hahaha. But I did do my best to support them as much as I could, and later 19th wavers produced short films over the summer. One 20th waver, Seo Jaehyun, made short films and also got into Columbia for film study. I enjoyed teaching this particular class because it was a combination of the student's interests and my interest. The students were actively involved which made me motivated to help them as much as I could! I had so many great memories with them in that class.

MH: Sounds like great fun! It is a pity that the course is no longer in our curriculum. Well, then, how did you start your career with KMLA?
Mr.Tweedie: Well, I was first an Education/Curriculum Research Member at Seogang University (서강대). My wife and I just had our second child and we were looking for a bigger apartment to move into. Then, the daughter of our friend who was planning to go to KMLA, told us that they were looking for a teacher at Minsa High School. As Wonju has a bigger living space than Seoul, I applied and was interviewed. I remember it was a rainy day, and until I got to the campus I knew nothing about the school. Hahaha. As I got to the school, I saw so many students wearing hanbok and no one spoke English! When I was confused and didn't know where to go, Suin Jeon, who was the head of the English Department at that time,

talked to me for a few minutes and guided me to the interviewing place. To be honest, I thought I messed up the interview. They were all looking at a different person's resume! Mr.Jeon had to correct them. But, yeah, I somehow got the job and lived on campus for the first year of my career with KMLA. But later I loved the school and the students so much that I decided to stay in the teachers' dorm.

MH: Wow, not knowing about the school and living on a pretty isolated campus must've quite been hard.
Mr. Tweedie: Well, yeah, but I think living and working full time in school helped me to get used to it. Especially getting integrated with the English Department, with Mr. Yoon, and his wife, Ms. Jeong, etc... They helped me to get used to the new environment. Also, I am thankful to Mr. Garrioch (he started a year after me) and Mr. Baumgardner, because being close to them helped me to feel like a part of the English Department and a KMLA family member. However, it was always the students who made me feel welcomed and appreciated in school. Yeah, when I think of KMLA, the first thing that pops into my head is the students.

MH: Sounds like you have many beautiful memories of this school. To you, what is the greatest charm of KMLA?
Mr. Tweedie: Well, the campus itself is really beautiful, and walking around the school is a relaxing activity. But I guess other than the campus, the people in KMLA are the greatest charm of the school. I was close friends with Mr. Baumgardner and Garrioch, and it was nice to have people you could easily be friends with and talk to, with not only school-related subjects but also just anything!
I'm not sure if this happens nowadays in KMLA, but I also enjoyed the times you could take students out, like to the rest stops nearby. One of my greatest memories was when I used to have the homeroom leader take all the students' McDonald's Breakfast orders, and then pick it up before coming to work. Hahaha.
Yeah, I also miss my homeroom as well. Did you see Garrioch's office? Yeah? Mine wasn't as cozy, but I tried to create a very chill atmosphere. You know, the sofas, and coffee storage for people to enjoy. I also had a guitar in my office. It was a gift from the 15th waver who left an extra guitar in my homeroom. Yeah, lots of good memories there, mostly involving students. And it always was the students.

MH: It sounds like you loved the school. Did you have any specific location you loved most?
Mr. Tweedie: Er.. I think it depends on the weather or time. I loved the auditorium, where the film studies took place. It was an evening class, since I was only available in the evening, and my students and I brought popcorn and snacks and used the projector to view the movies and laugh. Yeah, it was one of my favorite moments there. Also, the walk behind the school to the newer unused dorms was nice as well. The landscape of KMLA is one of its greatest charms. I particularly loved the gazebo in the back of the English Building.

MH: Oh, I'm not sure if you know but a few students hung a couple of hammocks in that gazebo. It is now one of the most competitive places you can take naps in.
Mr.Tweedie: Really! No way! I'm not sure if you know, but before Mr. Han was the principal, there was a brief time another teacher worked as the headmaster who made sleeping rooms available around campus. Yep, it was a very tumultuous time. One of the things he did was to use a classroom next to the library as a napping space! I guess the students liked it, seeing that it was always packed with them, but I thought it was gross. You had to get through them and it smelled weird... Haha anyway, a crazy time it was!

MH: Oh I saw one of the photos showing those classrooms! I thought it was nice, but thinking back it might be gross because of the smell. What was your best memory, during your time with KMLA?
Mr.Tweedie: Er.. I think the vision trip for the 19th wavers. When the 19th wavers were freshman, the Sewolho accident happened. Yeah, that was why the entire school field trip was banned for the entire year. So the next year, we had two Vision Trips, therefore they needed more teachers. Hence Mr. Garrioch and I were 'invited' to join the Europe trip. I loved teaching the 19th wavers because I think that they were memorable for being the most kind and respectful towards each other. They were

supportive and wonderful. So that's probably why I loved being a counselor for the Vision Trip as well.

I was especially amazed when we were going to the concentration camp in Germany. I am from a British household, and my grandparents fought in WWII. So I've lived with the weight of what this conflict and Holocaust was about. And I worried that maybe some of the students would take this site lightly and take a selfie or something. However, the level of respect and solemness they showed throughout the tour was amazing and I was proud to be their teacher. Other memorable moments there would be walking in the Netherlands, trying to keep students from buying beer, hahaha. It was one of the best trips I've ever been on.
Once you get to know your students, they somehow stop being 'students' and truly become person-to-person interactions where you can discuss and interact more freely and comfortably. I think that is one of the greatest perks I enjoyed there.

MH: Yep, having a teacher you can talk to is one of the charms of our school. This question is more "Minjok Herald" related, but when you were supervising the MH, were there any particular directions or aims?
Mr. Tweedie: I supervised the Minjok Herald until I left the school! Journalism was one of the things I studied in college, so I hoped to encourage students and help them with the things I know. Of course, there was always a conflict with the school censorships, and I realized that every edition is greatly influenced by the editor-in-chief. So I tried to make it closer to a magazine rather than a newspaper. For the 17th wave, Sophie Park, as editor, was dedicated to student politics and believed that we should act as real journalists to cover campaign platforms, student court proceedings.. etc...
But because of the tough articles and infrequencies, I tried to make Minjok Herald closer to a magazine where we both covered the good and bad, where students can freely write what they want to write while not having conflicts with the censoring.. hahaha.

MH: Did you have any favorite students?
Mr. Tweedie: Err.. the 14th waver Min Ju Kim. She and I were pretty great friends. I wasn't able to talk to her as much since I moved to Canada, but she is one of the students I remember from the school. Also one of the 19th wavers who studied at Stanford, California, contacted me when having a conference in Montreal. We met halfway in Cornwall and had lunch there.

Also, the 12th waver, Sunny Kim. She was the person who helped me feel like a member of the KMLA family when I started school. At the beginning, I had a hard time fitting in, and I was not fully engaged with the students and its members. Sunny one day came to me and invited me to play badminton with her friends. At first, I declined but she told me, " Mr. Tweedie, the students want to get to know you, you need to let us." I think that was a turning point for me. I went and played badminton, and KMLA started to become a place not only where I worked but lived. I am grateful to her for that.

Also finally, the 21st waver, Ji Soo Park. During my last year in KMLA, she asked me if I could be the counselor for her and LGBTQ friends to attend Pride in Seoul. Of course, I accepted, and it was one of the greatest moments in my life. Seeing the students feeling liberated and joyful, and able to support and help them, really made me happy. Here in Ottawa, every class has a rainbow heart showing that it is a "safe space" where everyone is accepted and respected. That's what I tried to make my classes be, a "safe space." I know that not everyone is open and accepting and it is not always a safe space for them. However, through my many actions and interactions, I tried to show more inclusiveness for the students.

MH: Well, when were the moments when you were proud to be a teacher?
Mr. Tweedie: I think the Pride festival was one of the many moments. The moments that made me proud to be a teacher of these wonderful students involved when they were advocating for themselves. Like when they were protesting against the unfair rules of the school, the candle protests, etc... They are doing them not because it is beneficial for their EC or Common Apps, but because

they are genuinely invested in these concepts and beliefs. Seeing students speak for themselves makes me proud.

Also, the Samuchim? Yep, they are amazing, the KMLA Orchestra, the Minjok Orchestra, the concerts held annually, and seeing wonderful performances put up by my students made me proud as well. And I think that is because I feel appreciated as a teacher. On Teacher's Day, rolling papers, and birthday surprises, the students make sure to show gratitude and sincerity. In my old office, there was a wall decor of a life-sized Batman and Superman. It was there because, on the morning of my birthday, two of my homeroom students secretly sneaked in and decorated the wall as a birthday surprise! It was amazing and warms my heart every time I think about them.

MH: The KMLA family spirit is something that makes our school different from any others.
Mr.Tweedie: Yeah! And they are not just formally saying it, they mean it when they say it. Each wave is different and unique in its way and their interaction with other people is something that I love seeing every year.
I'm sure in many schools in Korea, graduates gather annually to celebrate together. However, here in this school where I teach in Canada, those are usually just formalities - never something you'd voluntarily do. But here, it feels tied. Seeing alumni teaching in this school even years after graduation, you can see that this place has a close meaning to them.

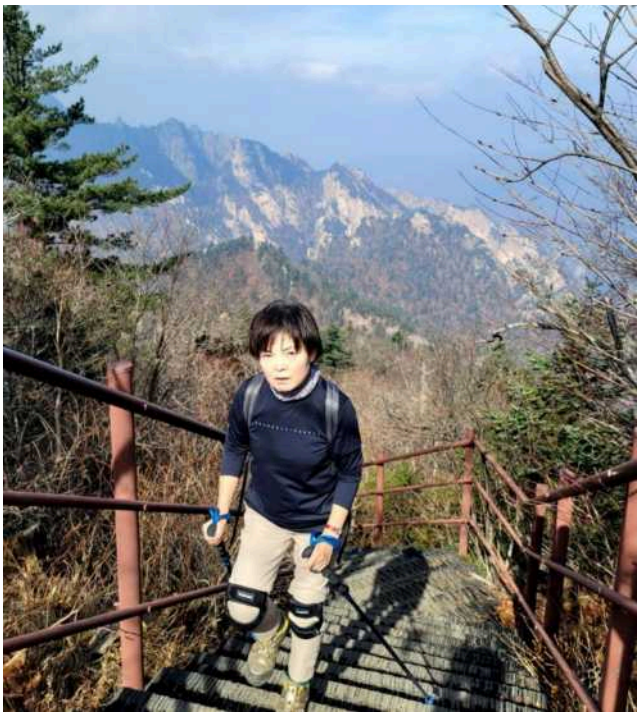
MH: In one word, how would you describe your time in KMLA?
Mr. Tweedie: Wow. Let's do that. Just "Wow". It was one of the best professional and personal experiences for me. And I would never trade it for anything.

MH: If you could go back to the time when you were a teacher, what would you say to your students?
Mr. Tweedie: I would just spend time and just talk to them like any time. I miss them. I probably romanticize the past too much; you know, they were all great. Even though I had to grade 2000 essays in a year, and college admission and acceptance seasons were not always easy, the people were wonderful, the students were amazing and they were what allowed me to move onwards and forward. So if I go back, I think I'll just talk and enjoy being with them once again.

MH: Oh for the last question, as this article will be largely distributed to other waves, from the first to the twenty-eighth, for those who may be curious, what did you do after your time in KMLA?
Mr.Tweedie: Well, I'm working at Nepean High School in the Ottawa-Carleton District School Board (OCDSB). Before that, I studied for two years to get a full license to teach in Canada.

Thank you so much for the questions! I had so much fun talking to you about the school and it was nice to reminisce about the memory I had with the school!

Ms. Hyeongu Jeon



MH: Hello! Before we begin, for the readers, please introduce yourself!
Ms. Jeon: Good Evening, My name is Jeon Hyeon Gu, I worked as a math teacher, focusing usually on Calculus from the year 2000 to 2018.

MH: And, how did you start your career with KMLA?
Ms. Jeon: I first learned about this school during my master's degree program in Canada. While I was debating whether or not I should continue the course to obtain my Ph.D., my younger sibling showed me an advertisement for a job opening in KMLA. I thought: "Why not? I'll use this chance to visit Korea" and did a few demonstrative classes in Hyeongsung. Later I got a call from the school to offer me the position. I finished my thesis paper, postponed graduation and joined the school around early August in the 2000s.

MH: What do you think is the biggest charm of KMLA?
Ms.Jeon: Umm... As far as when I was teaching in the school, unrestricted school life was a great appeal in the school. When I listen to the worries of my friends who work as teachers in other public schools in Korea, they complain that they are always tired and taxed, with mountains worth of workloads. However, during my time with KMLA, I always felt that the school allows the teachers to focus on their lessons, it gives teachers liberation to teach and spend their time with their pupils. Hence, I have a lot of positive memories regarding these times.

MH: Did you have any favorite places on the campus?
Ms.Jeon: One of the highlights of Minsa High School is experiencing the beauty of all four seasons. In my leisure hours, I developed a fondness for playing basketball, a small habit acquired during my time in Canada. Adjacent to the gym, there's a cluster of chestnut trees. I enjoyed collecting ripened fruits during the autumn seasons. My preferred spot on campus is the pathway leading from the Minjok Education Building to the gymnasium's backyard. The towering trees lining this walkway allow you to genuinely sense the changing seasons, from the crisp crunch of leaves underfoot to the presence of massive pine cones.

MH: Do you have any precious memories during your position as a math teacher?
Ms.Jeon: I do have one memory of when I was touched by my students. I think they were 11th or 12th wavers. It was after or a few days before Teacher's Day when one student called me to come outside the Dasan Building. I didn't know what was going on and thought something bad might've happened, so I ran outside. However, outside, my students were lined up on the stone bridge in front of the Dasan Building all holding beautiful rose blossoms. They gave me the roses, turning them into one big bouquet. I was touched by their actions and it was one of the moments I felt very glad to teach these students.

MH: How about students? Do you have any students you remember to this day?
Ms. Jeon: Two students I met during my teaching years left a great impression on me. When I was teaching in KMLA, the school wanted the students to follow EOP. Therefore, one of the policies they enforced was for every teacher to report at least one student who was not using English. I made an announcement to my homeroom class one day saying, "Please guys use English during school, or I'll have to report one of you!" When the students were leaving the class to join the next class, one student approached me and said, "If you don't have anyone to report, you can always put my name on the list." Another student who gave a strong impression was a student who helped me to carry a huge cassette box. For tests like the Korean SAT, the supervisor for the test needed to carry the cassette box by herself to the testing classroom. And I had a petite figure so carrying them around was a huge challenge. But one day, this student just walked next to me and helped me carry the record box, when all the other students were busy minding their own business. Both of these students showed altruism and a caring attitude towards others. Maybe that is why I remember these pupils to this very day.

MH: When were the moments when you were really happy to be a teacher in KMLA?
Ms.Jeon: Well, as a math teacher I usually taught Calculus and Advanced Calculus. Those were subjects I took during university, and while studying them, sometimes there were concepts that I was not able to fully understand. However, while working in KMLA, I had to teach these concepts to my students! Sometimes really advanced information I was not yet familiar with! However as I taught more students and more classes, I was able to

understand more about the subject and filled in the blanks I had. Realizing that I too was learning with my class was probably when I felt thrilled to be a teacher.

MH: In one word, how would you describe your time with the KMLA family?
Ms. Jeon: A beautiful nostalgia

MH: Looking back at the years in KMLA, do you have anything to say to your past self?
Ms. Jeon: Hmm.. looking back, I had great fun and lovely memories in KMLA. Of course, there were sometimes ups and downs, but overall I was happy. In that sense, to my past self, I'd like to say that you've had a great time in KMLA.

MH: How about your students?
Ms. Jeon: To my students, I want to say: "Have fun!" I believe enjoying the moment, having fun, and smiling are very important. In my case, for a 50-minute class, I spend around 10 minutes talking about things that are not related to math! I want the students to take studying and learning as a fun activity. It could be somewhat of a challenge to them, as teaching was for me. However, if we keep trying and putting in effort, then we can achieve the level we aspire to be. Just as I finally taught a class with no students dozing behind. So, have fun! And enjoy the moment!

MH: As this article will be distributed throughout the entire wave and teachers, they would probably be curious about your life after KMLA! Can you tell us a little bit about them?
Ms. Jeon: Oh well, after retiring, in 2019, I moved to England to study pottery for my master's degree. Because of COVID-19, I moved back to Korea earlier than I anticipated, and am now learning French. Sometimes I play the piano, do water paintings, or learn to play the drums, hahaha. I now invest my time in things I never had time for when I was teaching at KMLA. Now, since I have a lot of leisure time, I am trying new things for myself.

MH: Sounds like fun! Then, how did you get interested in pottery? Math and pottery... they don't seem to go together.

Ms.Jeon: Oh! I've always loved art when I was young. I wanted to advance to art school when I was young. Unfortunately, my father was against that idea, saying that arts are for hobbies, not something you do to make a living. So unfortunately I majored in math in college. When I was in KMLA, since 2009 I spent my evenings at an art academy in Wonju to study water coloring. There, I saw someone doing pottery and I got immersed in the world of pottery making. I wanted to study pottery more academically. So I applied to study Pottery in an undergrad program in England but later moved to England to study in a graduate program.

MH: Wow! That is amazing. Then the reason you study French is..?
Ms. Jeon: I studied French during my high school years. I always thought that French accents sounded beautiful and wanted to learn more about them. The reason why I was studying in Canada was because its national language is both English and French! If it was not for COVID-19, I would've studied French in France, but now I go to Élégance, a center for teaching the culture and language of France in Gangnam.

MH: It sounds like you are having the time of your life! Thank you so much for your wonderful interview!
Ms. Jeon: Thank you! The pleasure is mine!

Mr. Jeongmu Kim



MH: Hello! First, thank you so much for agreeing to participate in the interview!
Mr.Kim: No not at all! The pleasure is all mine.

MH: So, before we begin, for the readers of Minjok Herald, can you tell us a bit about yourself?
Mr.Kim: My name is Kim Jeong Mu, former Earth Science teacher at KMLA. I retired 2 years ago... oh in fact I officially retired 4 years ago, but I stayed in my position for 3 years, continuing to teach and advise bright young students of KMLA. During my post, I usually taught Earth science and environmental science, held a position in the administration office, etc...

MH: Then how did you start your career with KMLA?
Mr.Kim: In fact, I sub-majored in education at university. So, while studying Earth science, I was also studying to be a teacher. But, as life is unexpected, I went to the military to do my service for the country, and that later led me to be an officer as well. Afterward, I graduated from university and underwent a graduate course. After studying there, I was planning to go abroad to study, yet fate had a different plan in mind and I was hired by an atomic research center where I worked as a researcher for 10 years. That is probably when I realized the research job was not quite for me. I got my Ph.D. (which I was studying for while working as a researcher) and left for UC Santa Barbara for a doctoral program for 5 years. There I spent my days writing thesis papers and researching. Luckily at that time, KMLA was looking for a new teacher, and I got hired for the position in the year 2001. I had worked in the school for about 20 years before my retirement.

MH: What do you think is the greatest charm of KMLA?
Mr.Kim: Haha, the reason why I gave such a long description from the previous answer is this: I am a scientist, and have spent the majority of my life devoting myself to the field of science. But I am also someone who had spent a lot of his time wandering without a specific purpose. In the past, I didn't have a specific 'dream' I was more like a "going with the flow" type of guy. I simply do my best in any situation. So I later learned that knowing what you love to do, and want to do is very important. With the KMLA students, who are bright and passionate, I can help these students with my experience. Advising my pupils on their journey of finding their 'calling' in life, and what procedures they need to take to achieve that dream. For me, helping young people find their path, and seeing them being very happy and satisfied in their career brings great joy. That is one of the greatest charms of working in KMLA.

MH: Did you have any favorite place in Minsa High School?
Mr.Kim: Although I'm not Einstein or Newton, I do believe that to pursue science and make great experiments and discoveries, mental health is very important. That is why I love walking paths in KMLA. The trail that connects the Dasan to the gym was one of my go-to places when I was in my break time, or talking to my fellow teachers. Also, I have a secret passageway, a small walking path from the Golfing place to Changi Guan. I often went there to think about a new thesis paper or the worries of my advisor class. Walking and thinking there really helped me to clear my mind and refocus on the problem. To me, it was my 'thinking spot'.

MH: Do you have any memorable memories during your time with KMLA?
Mr.Kim: During my time as a teacher, I was able to meet a lot of gifted students. Er.. Park One Hee, one of the brightest students of KMLA, used to take my Environmental Science class. I was always happy to see many students finding their dreams and achieving them. Moreover, I feel very proud to have taught these students. A lot of people did not take my classes, usually 1st and 2nd years as a career choice. But later on, many more students got interested in the environment and enthusiastically joined and participated in my courses. I guess those are the moments that last with me to this day.

MH: Do you have any memorable students?
Mr.Kim: Hmm.. I used to advise a lot of students on writing their thesis papers on environmental science. For a few years, our school students participated in INEPO as the representative of Korea. And for that reason, I visited Turkey on multiple occasions. If you look closely at the small tombstone engraving you can see a few prizes won at

INEPO. I taught all of those students. As mentioned before, my greatest purpose is to help students independently reach their goals. Working with these students for over a year, and watching them enthusiastically participating in research was a memorable memory for me, and thus these students I worked with in the international competition were those whom I remember the most.

MH: When were the moments you were proud to be a teacher?
Mr.Kim: Probably when my students appear on TV, or win a grand prize. Hahaha. While I was teaching in this school I often saw a lot of despondent students. I wanted to help them gain their confidence again. So I encouraged them and supported them in any way I could. And seeing my students growing and developing into someone they once aspired to be, I couldn't be more happier! I think that is the greatest merit of being a teacher. If I were a professor at some university, I wouldn't have had this opportunity. Also, the students were very talented. I only taught them one thing, but they were able to create and achieve 9 or more! That went on as 10, to 100, to 1000! Because my pupils were as enthusiastic about learning, I was eager to aid them as well.

MH: In one word, or a sentence, how would you describe your time in KMLA?
Mr.Kim: Hmm.. I emphasized and unfolded everything I knew and studied at Minsa High School. I spent most of my time analyzing Earth chemistry, it is a very advanced and difficult term to understand easily. However, some students were interested in this topic and wanted to learn more about them. In university I absorbed as much knowledge as I could, there, I spent most of my time sharing and applying new facts that I have as much as I can.

MH: You seem to love KMLA, even after your retirement!
Mr.Kim: Ah! That is because I am not just a KMLA family member as a teacher, but also a parent! My son was an eleventh waver of Minsa. He, like any other student, found his dream during his three years of high school and now works as a professor in a university near Boston. I've loved this school as an educator and also as a parent of a student. That's why I and KMLA can never be separated despite my retirement.

MH: Well, as this article is also widely distributed to other students and teachers both current and former, they'd probably be wondering about your life after KMLA! Could you tell us a little bit about that?
Mr.Kim: Oh! Haha, well I think my picture can tell us about my life. When I was in a teaching position, I didn't have many opportunities to spend time for myself. As our school break is relatively short, and I also participated in the GLPS, I lived a very busy life. After my leave from school, I am still participating as a member of the school mountain climbing club. We hike long trails like the one in my picture once a month or two months. I now travel abroad and do a lot of leisure activities. Well, I think you can say that I am now living the life of a KMLA graduate's parents rather than a KMLA teacher's life. Hahaha. For my health, I focus on two things. I go to the city library to borrow and read books to enhance my intellectual skills, and walk mountain trails, and exercise for my physical health. When it is my birthday, a few of the graduates and my former students send me cards and happy birthday messages which really make up my day.

Having leisurely time for myself is great, but I guess no longer being an active member of the KMLA branch could be one of the downsides of my retirement. Maybe one day when there is time, I hope that there will be an opportunity for all of the KMLA family to gather in that beautiful school to feel unity once again. Even in my retirement, I will always look out and hope for the best of the school.

MH: Then, if you could go back to the past, and talk to your students again, what would you say to them?
Mr.Kim: Hmm.. I'd say to them, "You can do it. Believe that you can do it. And then you can do it". From my experience as a parent of a once-used-to-be KMLA student, I'd say I've seen a lot of students losing their confidence being around all kinds of talented students. My son, for instance, was very unprepared for the Minsa life. He had struggled to keep up with the classes and

understand hard concepts. But he could look at his friends and people around him and learn how to study. So, like him, you can do anything. Don't be pressured by the storms. If you can endure them you will get somewhere. Hang on! And your dream will come true!

MH: Thank you for such moving words! I'm sure a lot of people can relate to this quote
Mr.Kim: No, the honor is all mine! I'm sure there are still many students stressing over the new environment and mountains of workloads. In those times of difficulties, please think of the reason why you came to KMLA. Ponder what you did to come to this very space and HANG ON!

Mrs. Gwidong Lee

MH: Hello, it's such a great honor to be able to interview you. Please introduce yourself.
Lee: I'm a parent of Dongkwan Shin, the 15th waver of KMLA. Currently, I work as a patent lawyer.

MH: Why did your family choose to attend KMLA for your son's high school experience? What were the intriguing factors that led to this decision?
Lee: Our son decided to apply to KMLA a bit impulsively, not some super thought-out choice. Back in 2008, after two years in the U.S., he started 8th grade in Korea, and there was this big hype about specialized high schools. So, caught up in the moment, our son, influenced by the vibe, thought it'd be cool to go to one.

He was all about math and science at first, aiming for a science-focused high school. But, after checking out a few prep academies, he realized getting ready for that kind of school needed not just good scores but also a solid base in advanced math, which he didn't have at the time. My take was that no matter what happened with high school admissions, the fact that our son was keen to study for a specific goal was what counted. So, even though I was all for him prepping for a science-focused high school, none of the academies wanted him for that.

Funny enough, the one academy that did take him, despite him being unprepared, was KMLA. Looking back, it seems like a lucky break in our son's life, even if it was somewhat ironic how it all worked out.

MH: Where are some most memorable places that you remember vividly around KMLA?
Lee: Instead of having a top pick for a favorite spot, the one that stood out was the pedestal for the Nobel Prize, tucked on the right side when you walked through the school's main gate. Even though they've moved the main gate now, back when it was along the path past the Pasteur factory, there was this pedestal near the entrance. I'd read about it in a book by the founder, Myungjae Choi before our son even started at KMLA. Seeing it in person was a whole different thing. I remember picturing our son standing on that pedestal, getting some kind of recognition as he walked into the school.

MH: What are some most memorable moments as a KMLA family?
Lee: Around 13 years ago, in our son's first year, there was this farming thing where parents were invited to jump in. Even though most of us were city folks, a bunch of parents, including one dad who knew the rural ropes, got super into it and took the lead. We were all hands on deck—digging ditches, planting seeds, covering them up with plastic, and watering away. Students, teachers, and parents, we all teamed up like one big happy family. Once we were done and the sun went down, we kicked back and savored some grilled meat together. It was a blast, kind of like a massive family get-together.

MH: What were some proudest moments as a KMLA family?
Lee: Undoubtedly, I witnessed the achievements of KMLA alumni, both domestically and internationally, especially those in my workplace. Seeing their remarkable success and recognition makes it a joyous experience, akin to watching my children succeed.

MH: Are there any special triggers that remind you of KMLA after graduating many years ago?
Lee: Even though a decade has passed since our son graduated, we still regularly meet with some parents from his time. Every time we meet, memories of the experiences

and developments of our children during their time at KMLA resurface.

MH: Could you describe what KMLA is to you in 3 words?
Lee:
- Happy School: "KMLA fosters an atmosphere where students, despite their academic performance, feel a sense of self-worth and contribute to the community."
- Eternal Family: "Being a KMLA alumna or alumnus instantly creates a feeling of familiarity and a desire to help, no matter where or when."
- Proud Medal: "Being recognized as a parent of a KMLA graduate is a source of pride, and people express envy asking about the unique educational methods of KMLA."

MH: Who would you recommend KMLA to?
Lee: To anyone inquiring about their children's education. There is no alternative to recommend other than KMLA.

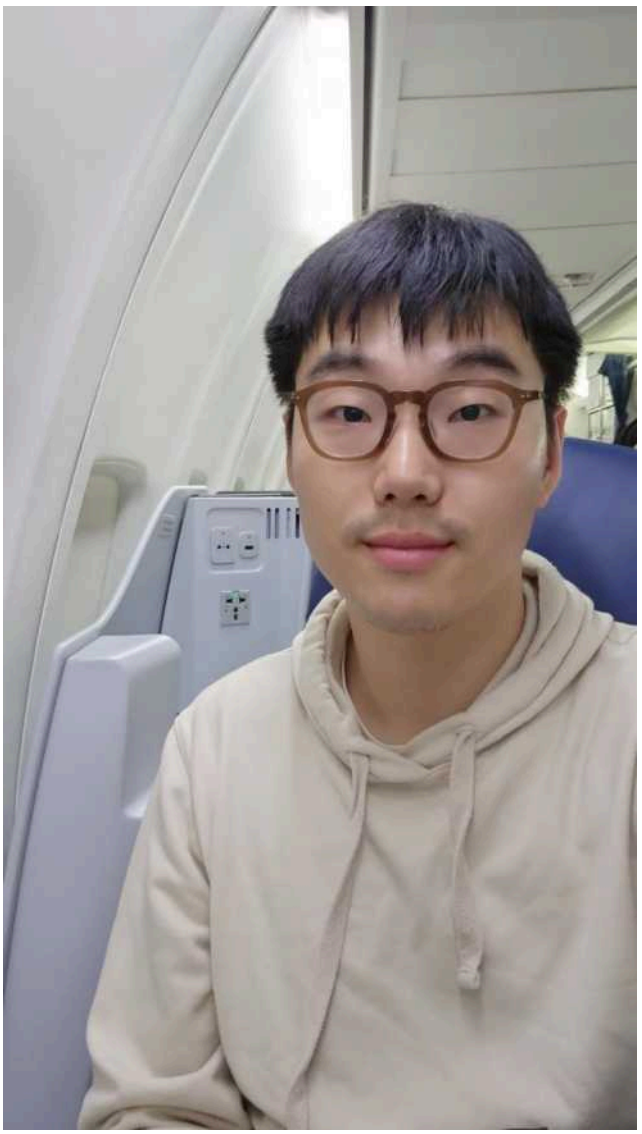
MH: Is there anything you want to do differently if you could go back in time? Would you still choose KMLA even if you could reverse your choice?
Lee: If I had a time machine, no doubt, I'd still pick KMLA. Those three years our son spent there dished out experiences you just can't find anywhere else. See, my kid's a bit on the introverted side, and not super keen on jumping into activities. But after soaking up the KMLA vibe for three years, he headed off to college and suddenly became Mr. Social, tackling all sorts of challenges. It wasn't his style, but he figured out how to handle it during his high school days.

Sure, I'm a tad bummed that he developed this strong independence at KMLA. Even now, when some situations could use a bit of parental advice, he's all "I got this, I'll handle it myself."

MH: When did you feel like you were a true member of KMLA?
Lee: Being the president of the 2023 Sarang Association, the KMLA graduate alumni parent group, is when I truly feel like part of the family. Even parents of 5th-wave students step up without a second thought when we ask for support. It's not about calculating incentives or what they can get out of it—they just ditch everything to help us out when it's about the school. It's a real "leave no one behind" kind of vibe.

MH: Are there any last words for the past/current/future KMLA family?
Lee: A lot of KMLA grads are probably headed toward leadership roles in society. Even with all the changes in the world and shifts in education, I hope that these grads won't lose sight of their mission—to carry on the Noblesse Oblige spirit and show, through what they do, the special qualities they gained from KMLA's education. It's the way to live up to the founder's words: "Take responsibility 20 years from now."

Doosan Baik



MH: Please introduce yourself briefly.
Baik: I am Doosan Baik from 11th wave international program. After studying computer science at Cornell, I've been working as a software engineer and engineering manager since 2012 in New York City. Recently, I've been teaching computer science at a local university in the city as well.

MH: What was the reason you decided to attend KMLA?
Baik: My mom was a middle school teacher back when I was in middle school, and one day she brought me a newspaper advertisement about a KMLA information session. I was preparing for the entrance exam of science high schools, but became interested in KMLA thanks to its more well-rounded curriculum across humanity, social science, science and technology.

MH: In one word, how would you describe your time at KMLA?
Baik: Growth.

MH: What was the most memorable moment as a student at KMLA?
Baik: In my senior year, I was featured on a TV program called "Documentary 3-days" on KBS as a main character. Originally, my roommate who was formerly a head of executive council in our 11th grade, was supposed to be the main protagonist; however, one of the producers took a video of me when my roommate wasn't in the room and decided to follow me for the remaining 3 days. They told me that I was filmed as a backup originally - however, it was all cover! By telling me I was a backup, I acted more naturally, and my schedule wasn't altered by the school (i.e., showing more of the natural life of a random KMLA student). On the day of broadcast in March 2008, I didn't even expect that I would be on TV, and my phone inbox was flooded with text messages from everyone in my contact. Back then, I was a bit embarrassed by people recognizing me on the street and felt lots of pressure, considering it was my senior year at high school; however, now, I appreciate that a small part of my life at KMLA was captured on TV and now on Youtube too.

MH: Is there anything you want to do differently if you could go back in time?
Baik: To be perfectly honest, not really. As much as I achieved a lot, I've also made my fair share of mistakes during my time at KMLA, and all these mistakes helped me grow into who I am right now; I've learned a lesson every step along the way. For example, since I wasn't originally very close to one of my roommates in senior year, I started my senior year with a lot of anxiety; however, he turned out to be the best roommate that I've had at KMLA. He and I got along very well, and we complemented each other; he even introduced me to his own friend group to whom I've rarely spoken for the first 2 years. Making such mistakes helped me become more of an open-minded person always trying to understand another person fully from my very own perspective.

MH: Did you have any favorite places on campus?
Baik: My favorite place on campus was the room D-223, the office of Ms. Hayeseon Park who taught earth science and led school-wide counseling programs (including the peer counseling club, Socksackim, which I was head of in 2007). Ms. Park's office was a safe haven for me - I was there not only to help out the counseling programs, but also to sometimes run away from the reality of being a high school student. Ms. Park always offered some tea and snacks, and just sitting in that office made me feel relieved from every possible anxiety; she was one of the adults many of us could fully trust. Unfortunately, Ms. Park passed away in 2014 with cancer and I dearly miss her. Now, as an adult, at every opportunity possible, I aspire to be "Ms. Park" for other people in younger generations.

MH: What goal did you have at KMLA and did you achieve it?
Baik: Personally my goal was to survive and graduate from the school; I honestly didn't really have any other goals. Considering 12 out of 44 class hours per week were English and all other class textbooks were written in English, I had struggled in my first year as a student who entered with not-so-great English proficiency; even my mathematics scores were impacted since I wasn't able to understand the questions themselves. Looking back, I can

confidently say I've achieved the goal of survival eventually.

MH: How did you achieve your goal?

Baik: I've always believed that the outcomes never betray the effort. In my second semester at high school, one of the required courses for International Program students was English Literature taught by Ms. Helen Jeong (and it was by far my favorite class that I took at KMLA). I received 73 out of 100 for midterm, almost at the bottom of the class, without much hope of getting an A at final. Especially during the second half of the semester, I had to read the book, "A Tale of Two Cities" by Charles Dickens, which was almost 500 pages long. Instead of relying on Cliffnotes or Sparknotes, I decided to take thorough notes during the class and write my own Sparknotes by asking questions to Ms. Jeong using the Individual Research (IR) times. I received 92 out of 100 in the final exam, which resulted in the final score of 89.5 turning out to be A with rounding. It was the moment that made me continue trying through the rest of my time at KMLA; I learned that I can achieve anything as long as I keep trying.

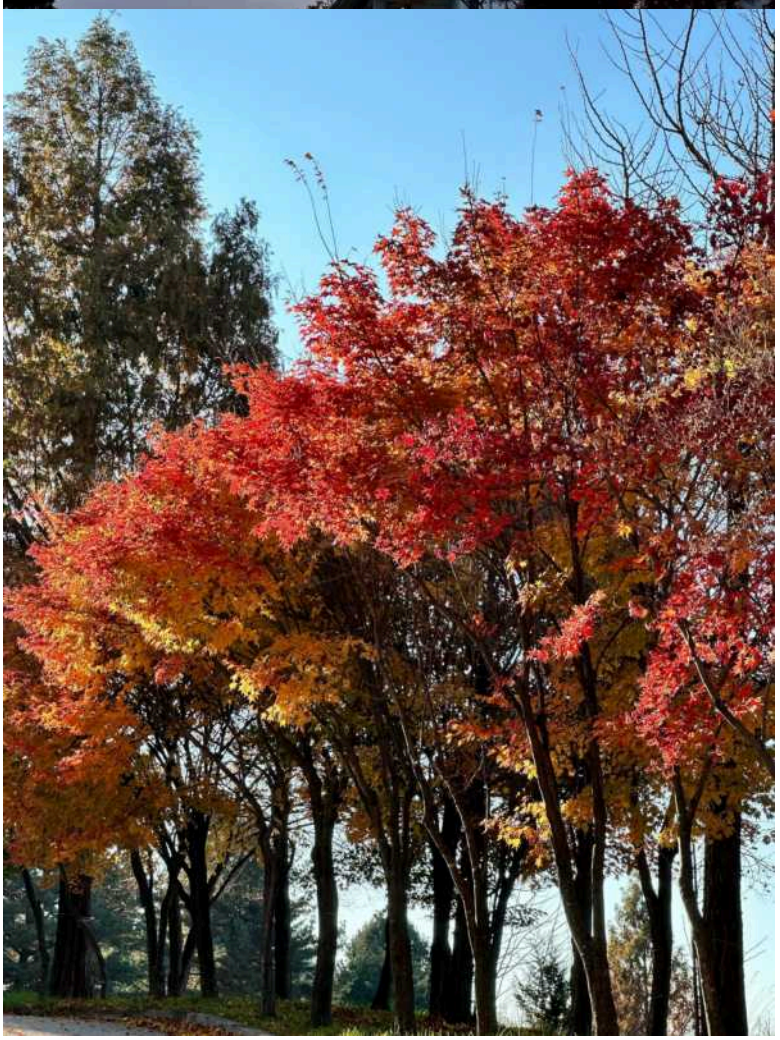
MH: What impact did KMLA have on your life?

Baik: KMLA also defined who I am and helped me realize what I like, what I do well. If I had gone to science high school, probably I would've participated in science-heavy extracurricular activities only. At KMLA, I had an opportunity to lead a peer counseling club (Socksackim), participate in a Korean newspaper club, while pursuing my academic interest in the fields of STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics). Such diversity in experiences helped me grow into a more well-rounded person.

MH: Do you have any last words for your fellow KMLA family members?

Baik: We call ourselves 'KMLA family', as we not only study but also literally live together. Treat everyone around you like your real family members; simply don't hate or badmouth each other. After 3 years at KMLA, even the transcripts and the grades will become something from the past, but the relationship you build will last forever.





Unveiling the Stargazer: Illuminating the Genius Behind Start-Ups

Inyoung Yi

In our collective pursuit to change the world and leave an enduring impact on society, the avenues for transformation are diverse. Amidst these paths, individuals within private companies have played a pivotal role in molding the world into the familiar landscape we inhabit today. One such luminary among our alumni is the remarkable Sujin Lim, who stands as the reigning queen of start-up companies, influencing the very fabric of our global society. This exclusive interview, conducted on the 3rd of January via Zoom, unveils the insights and perspectives of Soojin Lim, the 8th waver of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy.



MH: It's such a pleasure to meet you. Please introduce yourself freely!

Lim: I'm the 8th waver of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy, and I was in the international class at that time. I got into the University of Pennsylvania early in the Huntsman Program, which studies business and international affairs integrated. I majored in finance, international politics, and Chinese. This became the road for my current life. When I was in KMLA, all of the teachers knew that I wanted to become a diplomat. Back then, if we wanted to become a diplomat, we had to study for the foreign service examination, and during junior term, we had to live somewhere unknown, rotating through various countries. As an international student, it was hard to change from what I originally studied to the foreign service examination, and as a woman, in order to build a family of my own, I had a lot of different thoughts about whether it would be possible when I'm living in Africa. The main reason why I wanted to become a diplomat was that I wanted to give social impact to the world. The other way to do so was not working in public institutions but going to private institutions, managing private companies. I was supposed to go into investment banking, but lots of my university alumni back then were starting start-up companies in Korea, which was Ticket Monster in 2010. I got into a different company, but my alumni's business looked so fun, and watching them grow rapidly, I thought it would be much better to live a life with a huge impact by staying in a start-up company, not getting a lot of money from other companies. I was like the first or second full-time employee of Tmon. In 2010-2013, Tmon was growing way faster than Coupang (a famous company now), and that was the most successful founded company. Me working at that company specifically during that time of huge expansion had a huge impact on my career. Then why did I come out of Tmon so fast? Mainly, Tmon was the most famous commerce website in 2013, and there was a major mergers and acquisition that involved around $200 million USD. This changed my role there from finance managing to building a business, and I was like 25, 26, and I had a lot of dreams back then, so I resigned. I

had some regrets of my own that I never had work experience outside of Korea. After all, I studied in America, but I never really had a chance to work in a foreign country as I came straight back to Korea for Tmon. There was a company named Ebates in the USA (it's something like OK cashback in Korea. Reward service like you get $10 if you spend $100). This reward service was a boom in Korea back then, I don't even know why. Ebates was looking for a manager in Asia as they were wondering why this was happening. I worked in that Asia branch in Singapore for about 2 years. During those 2 years, reward services indeed grew tremendously. There's a company called Rakuten in Japan, which is a large shopping mall and a wire service. There was a merger between these companies which involved about $1 billion USD (back then). There was an exit this once and then I worked for 3 years more, 6 in total as Korea manager. After 9 years of harsh work experience, I began to wonder if I'll be able to work with that much energy that founding requires in my 30s as well. It was 2018, and in that time period, lots of venture capital start-up companies changed their career to investing work. That's when I joined my current company Dunamu and Partners. It's an investment subsidiary of Dunamu (the most successful start-up myth of all time in Korea like *Carrot Market, Deliver Minjok*, etc. now). The start-up's main existence purpose is to grow rapidly with a lot of sales and profit, and Dunamu earned the most amount of money out of all start-ups in South Korea in 2018, 2019 when the virtual currency market opened by UPbit service management. I joined this company in its baby stage, and I've been working on investment work for about 6 years now.

MH: Wow! What a journey you've been through. I'm sure you would have a lot of founding advice as someone who has delved into start-up companies for a long time. Do you have any advice for KMLAians interested in founding companies?

Lim: There are a lot of smart students in KMLA, and I really hope those smart students will go for founding. Many students in Korea nowadays aim for medical school or engineering, and that might be a great choice for individuals, but I think the weapon we can have that can influence our ability to many different individuals is by establishing. Doctors can surely play a huge role, but there's a limit in who we can cure the number of people and a specific section they can work in. The same with professors; they impact a specific section in theory. However, start-ups and founders have an experience of delving into everyone's everyday life, such as Coupang and Dunamu that I worked in. The kind of impact that these innovations can bring is way more powerful than any other career or academics. If you want to be good and successful in start-up companies, you need a lot of capability and ability. I think people who are smart and have big dreams have a higher chance of succeeding in start-up companies. It's not an option that everyone fits in. You have to work for a long time with a lot of pain, and if your purpose and motivation are not clear enough, it's very hard to go through the journey till the end. If you are someone who really wants to found a company, then you should go into a big start-up and work there and learn over other people's shoulders. Maybe join an internship. Systematic preparation is necessary. For KMLAians specifically, there are a lot of alumni currently that can help you out in this process, so if there is someone who dreams of founding, then there would be a lot of help open for you.

MH: Now I'm dragged into founding a company myself! Do you have any special tips of your own that helped you develop many different brands?

Lim: I think the people who make their life with a lot of progress and value are people who have the ability to keep on trying till you see the victory. In KMLA, I had a lot of experience myself in the most extreme scenarios. This kind of doing it till the end, the grit, perseverance, is something really useful. If we think about it, it's just a law of nature that it requires a lot of time and effort. You need to be persistent to be good at it.

MH: I'll definitely be persistent in my life. I think you mentioned a bit about the reason you were delved into start-ups. Could you please tell us more about the charms of start-up companies?

Lim: Founding is a very special job sector. Most people work at a company and work on the goals that are provided by the company passively. That's work

experience that we're used to, but start-ups and founding are a more active environment that asks for what you want to do, what you are interested in, and what kind of pace you want to do that. When you work in this specific job sector, we can meet many different owners full of optimism and energy that grind their best with their life. I think it's a huge blessing that I get to work with people who seek for positive change all the time. Start-up company owners have different concerns compared to the CEO of Samsung or other huge companies. I think looking at people who grind their life to achieve something is the biggest reason I remain in this field.

MH: Aww. That's something I would want to resemble. Do you have any special memories during your job life?
Lim: Oh, there's plenty of things I remember. When I was in TMon, I was in charge of marketing and advertising, and one of the things that we did was a service, something to do with restaurants. There was a case where the product was canceled, and the entire service was in a state of falling apart. Everyone from the CEO to web designers, and everyone in all fields of work went around to every restaurant we can find in Seoul, advertising our service. This is start-up culture. There is a standard of 'this is your job', but one main goal for everyone is wanting to make this company succeed and doing any kind of work in order to achieve that goal. The place I experienced this the most was Tmon.

MH: That sounds like a journey. Now moving on to a bit of a personal life of your own, as a graduate of KMLA, it would've been a long time for you since you were a student here. Do you still keep in touch with fellow students from KMLA? How were you able to remain friends till now?
Lim: Honestly, I talk with all alumni, whether they're older or younger, all the time. Looking back at my life, the most important people are my high school friends. When we are in a social life, inevitably there's some kind of conditions when meeting or forming a relationship. However, KMLAians feel like the people who don't require a condition when meeting. I can meet them without anything really comfortably, and it feels like I've seen them every day even though it's been a long time since I've actually seen them. There's a culture where everyone aims to help each other and the relationship feels genuine. It's like a Kakaotalk group chat that has alumni related to founding, so we meet often and chat a lot. I try to help them out the best in things I can do to help like hiring people, organizing business, and so on.

MH: I'm proud to be part of the KMLA family. Who knows someday I might join your founding group chat! Do you have any special memories with KMLA?
Lim: I still remember the time that we went out to participate in the Gangwon State Championship for Kendo. It was really tiring to go on morning exercise every day, but looking back, it was a great experience and one of the most important training of my life. Doing one thing consistently for a long time in an extreme environment, and even though we weren't an amazing team trying hard to win is a memory I remember the most. I remember the vision trip as well, as I fell in love with UPenn. It was a great trip looking around all different schools laying my eyes on something and experiencing what it would be like in university. Of course, there are plenty more little things I remember about my high school life.

MH: Awww, I did love the vision trip as well. As a current student of KMLA, I don't really agree with loving morning exercise but maybe I will after I graduate;) Will you send your children to KMLA?
Lim: Of course, I would 100%, as long as they accept my children. I think KMLA is a way of learning social life faster and effectively. Living in a dorm in such an isolated place with limited resources, we experience a lot of pain in coming up with new things. That's really similar to actual social life. I think I learned a lot by adapting to a new environment, finding things of my own, my value, and things like this and that's how I was able to fit in America really quickly as well. Even in harsh conditions like founding, I was able to have a 'Just do it' mindset. If my children can get in, I'm sending them.

MH: I hope your children have a great experience in KMLA as much as you did. As a Minjok Herald member, myself I've heard that you were a Minjok Herald crew. I can't help but ask you, do you have any memories of your time in Minjok Herald?

Lim: Back then, there weren't any digital versions but printed ones. There were only a few students as well. I received the most recent copy of MJH, I think the 68th one, and it was so thick I was surprised by it. I think we didn't work on it as hard as you guys did. It was in the 6th wave that the international class became very active, and Minjok Herald was founded in the 8th wave. It became really popular with everyone wanting to be part of it. There weren't that many means we could search for things to write about because we didn't really have the internet. So for us, the main task was figuring out what to write about. Now it's easier to gain information since there are so many means per sector, but we didn't have that so we had to think and think about article topics. That's my excuse for having a short edition. But, you guys did amazing.

MH: Thank you for such kind words. I'm sure your edition would've been amazing as well. Talking to you, even though I've just met you made me realize how amazing a person you are. Do you have any tips for having such a mindset or any life mottos?

Lim: I think it's important to have a lot of interest in how the world changes. It's really easy to make a choice for ourselves. A high annual income, a great car, a nice apartment, etc. are something that can make me happy as an individual. However, for me, due to my job environment, I always think about how the world changes. How does school change? How do other countries change? I have a lot of exposure to what brings growth and excitement. More trials and errors. What's there in the world other than myself. Questions productive like these are things I always wonder about. It is true that in life we worry about our grades, preparing for university, preparing for jobs, and doing these things makes us grounded in a certain box taking up our all attention, but in these environments it's more important to think about how the world is changing and how am I coping with it in order to make good decisions. I think thinking about such matters

MH: It was truly heartfelt advice. To conclude this interview, do you have any advice for current KMLA students?

Lim: For me, the time of my life is somewhere between high school and university. If I could go back to my high school life and make different decisions, I would tell myself that it's really important to make decisions that I truly want instead of listening to what other people say. Whatever you major in, whatever university you go to, whatever you study, this is the chance for you to make bold decisions and the opportunity in your life to use those chances well to create a better version of yourself. I hope all of you have great confidence in yourselves and make different attempts in life.

The Minjok Herald
Glimpse of KMLA Life







MINJOK HERALD

“Rather than love, than money, than fame, give me truth.”

- Henry David Thoreau

69th Edition



